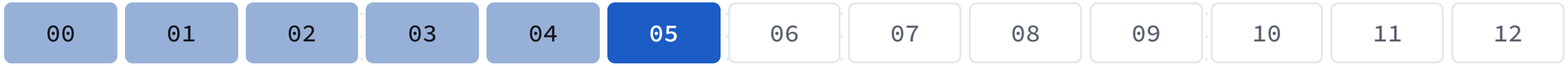
MODULE 05 · AMBITIOUS ENTREPRENEURSHIP

The Solution Space

Of all the ways to solve this problem, why this one?

COURSE PATH



COURSE MATERIAL · SCAN NOW

All slides live on GitHub

The newest version, free, no account needed

github.com/BaNburger/
AmbitiousEntrepreneurship

1. **Open the link**
   github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship
2. **Go to modules**
   then 05-solution-space
3. **Click the lecture PDF**
   M05_Lecture_Solution-Space.pdf, download top right

Public course repository of Ambitious Entrepreneurship. The QR code opens github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship.

WHERE WE ARE · THE COURSE

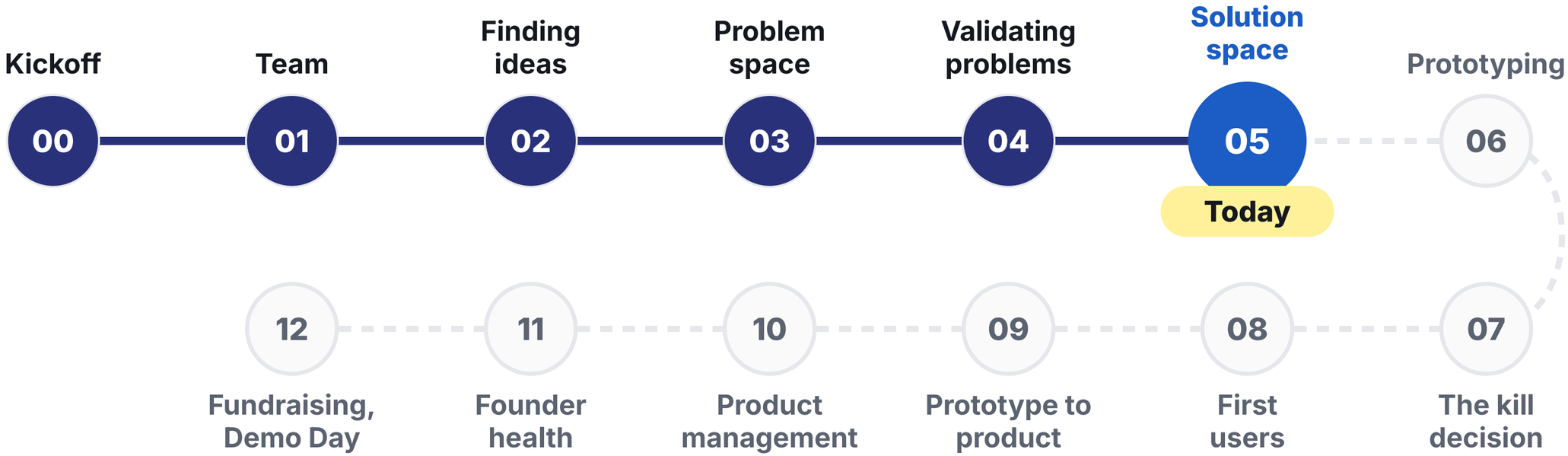
From one problem to many solutions

Thirteen sessions from first idea to first revenue. What teams have by now:

A problem people confirmed
Problem space (M03)

A landing page with its line
Validating problems (M04)

Sign-ups from their segment
Validating problems (M04)



CHECK-IN · SHOW OF HANDS

Did your page beat your line?

Hands up for your band. One click on the band per hand

Above

the line

your page beat it

Under

the line

a result, not a failure

No line

written

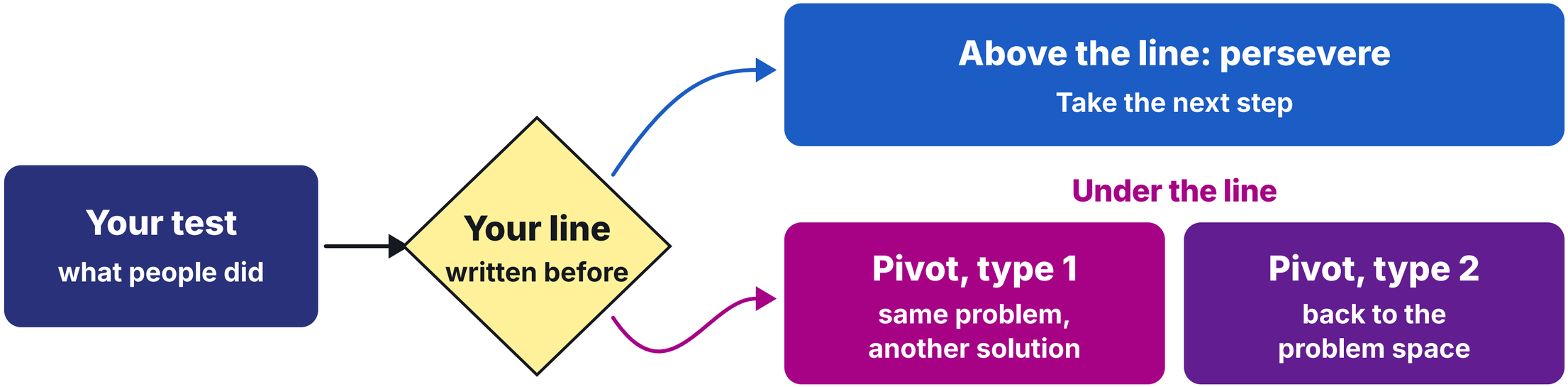
draw it first next time

2:00

PIVOT OR PERSEVERE

Under your line? That is a decision, not a failure

Every test ends in one of two moves, and both are progress



Both are progress. The only miss: no line, so no decision

FRAMEWORK Pivot or persevere after Ries, E. (2011), The Lean Startup. Pivot types as in the course Glossary.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Report what you did, not what you planned



User interactions?

What did you learn?



New revenue?

Why did they pay?



Shipped?

Why does it matter?

🦄 **Report target vs. actual in small groups**

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

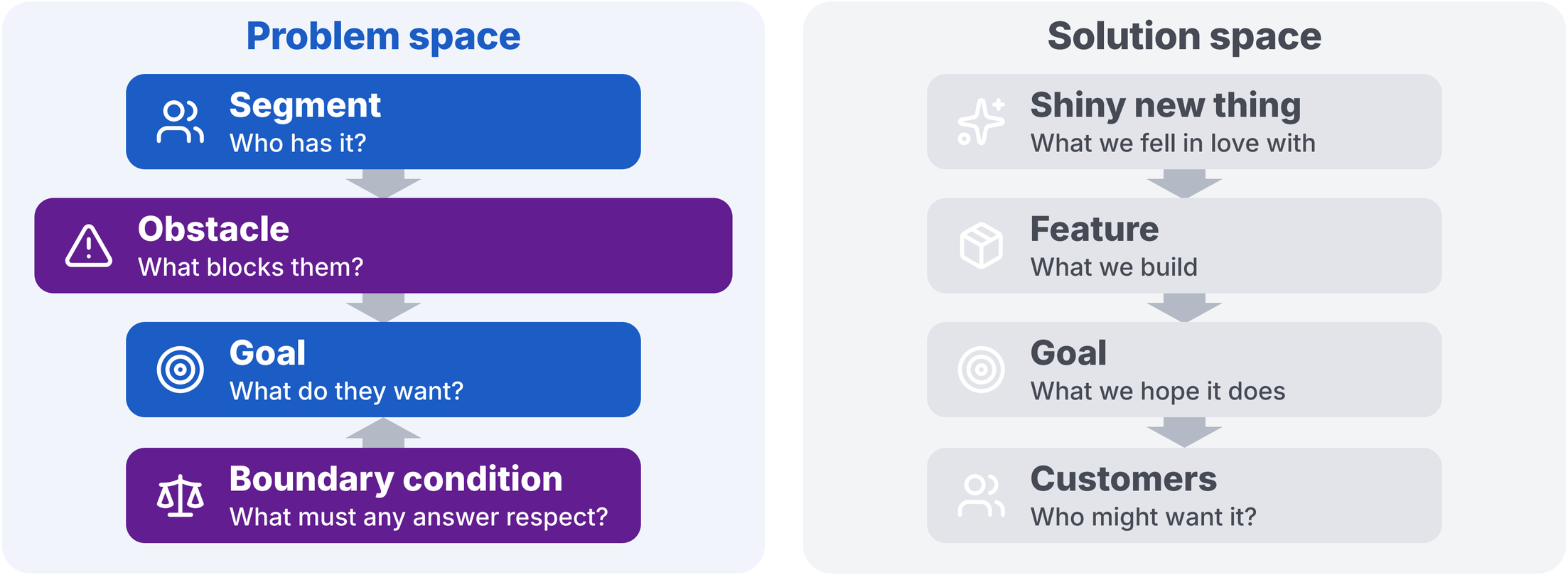
Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

Four pictures from earlier sessions that you need to follow today.

01 **Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship**
02 Your presentations
03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**
04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**
05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**
06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos
09 Case discussion

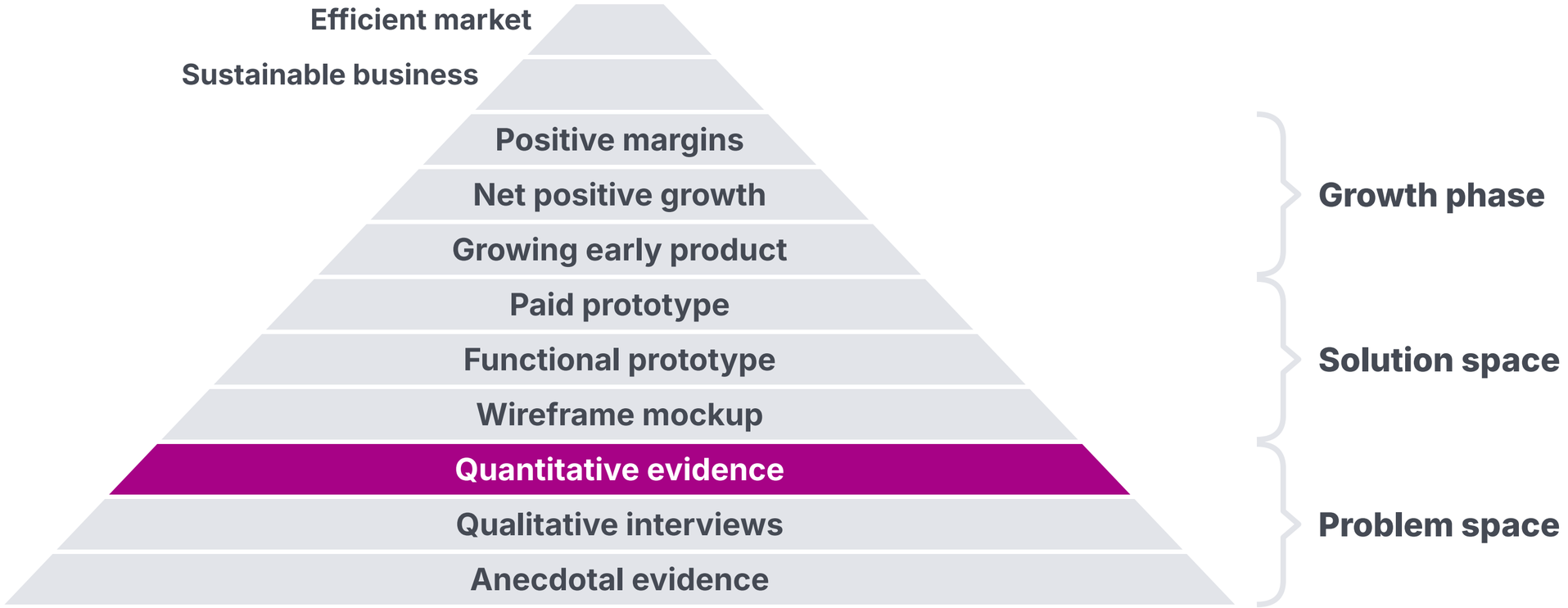
PREVIOUSLY · PROBLEM SPACE (M03)

You started left. Today, the right side



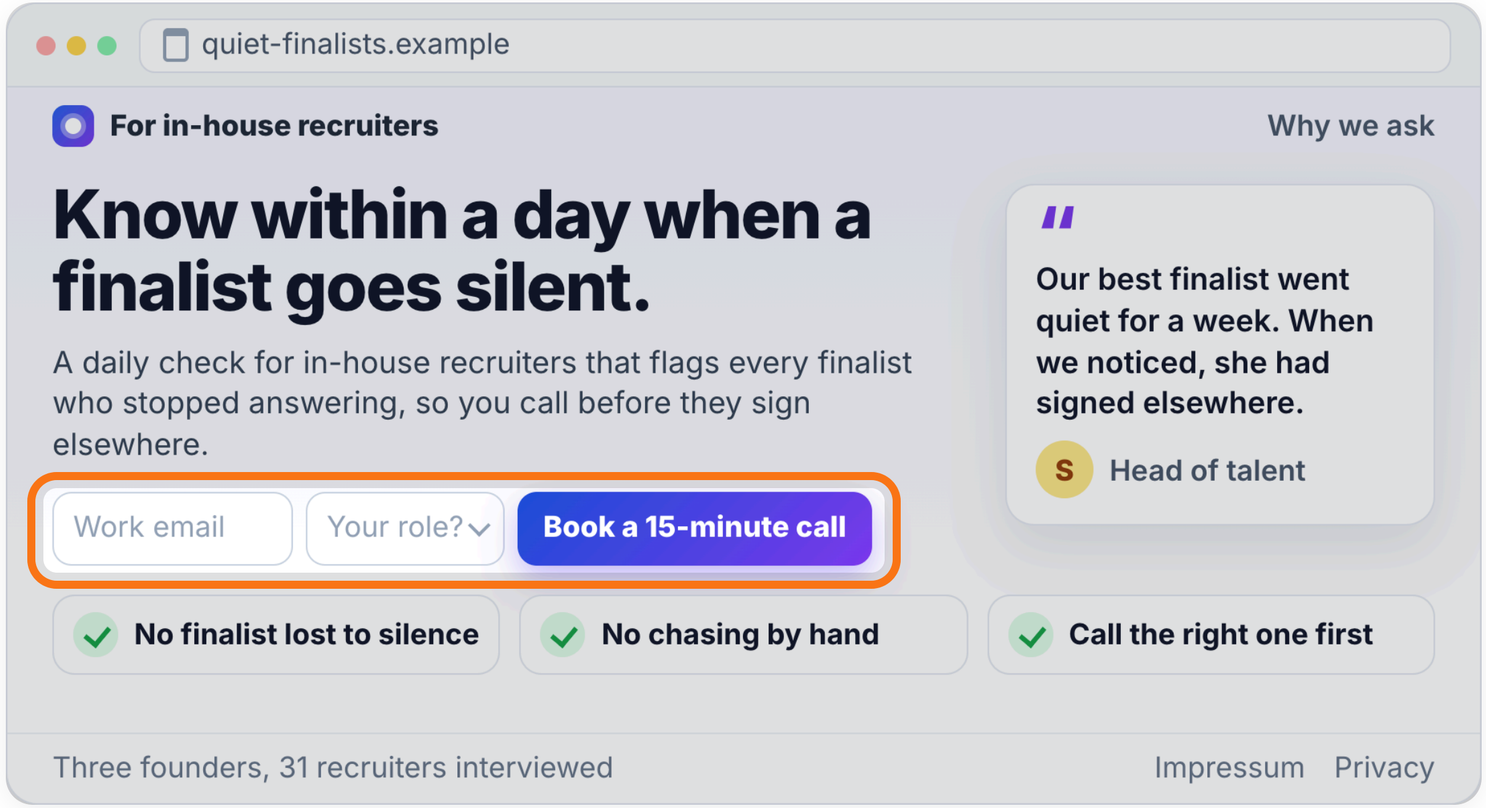
PREVIOUSLY · VALIDATING PROBLEMS (M04)

You climbed to a number



PREVIOUSLY · VALIDATING PROBLEMS (M04)

Your page asked for one action

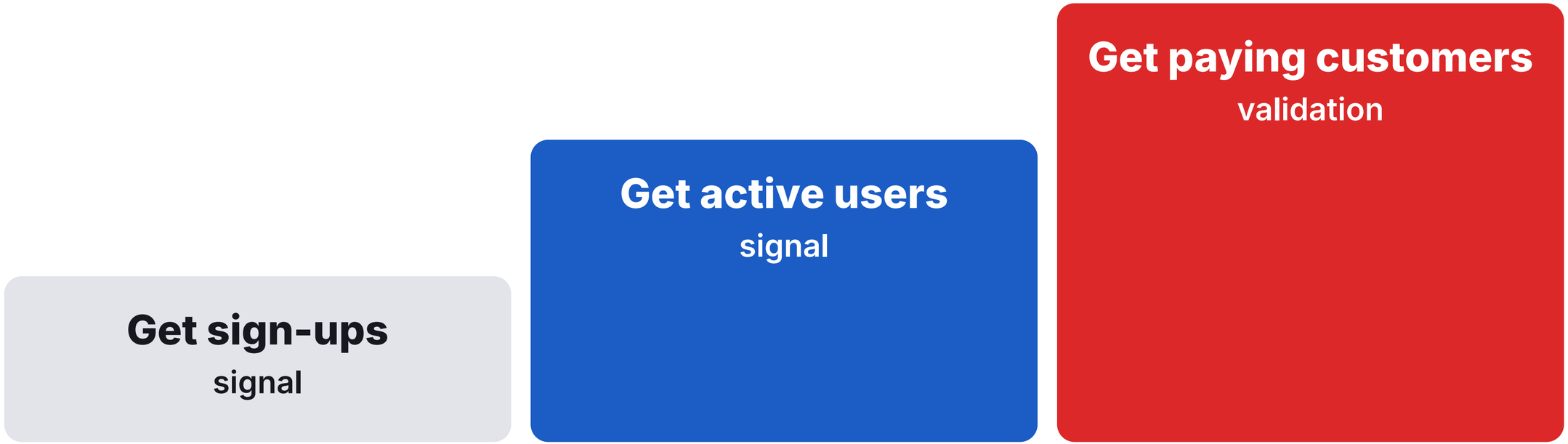


From today, that button leads to your click dummy, a clickable mock-up with nothing behind it.

ILLUSTRATIVE Page prototyped for this course, the made-up recruiting team of the workshop.

PREVIOUSLY · VALIDATING PROBLEMS (M04)

Real validation comes through the credit card



TODAY'S QUESTION · HANDS

Of all the ways to solve this problem, why this one?

1:00

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

Your presentations

Your line next to your number, three minutes per team.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 **Your presentations**

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

YOUR PRESENTATIONS · MAKE IT CREDIBLE

3:00

Show us where you're at in 3 minutes or less!

Facts

Statistics or research

The benchmark behind your line

12 Numbers

Usage or surveys

Line next to your rate, visitors per student, conversion per source

Quotes

Interviews

Two answers to "why did you sign up?"

Images

Screenshots or users

Page above the fold, analytics by source

Verdict: pass or fail, and what it triggered

What did you do? | **What did you learn?** | **How can we help?**

INPUT 1 OF 4 · CHAPTER 3 OF 9

Widen it: many solutions to one problem

Write several solutions to your tested problem, then let what people do pick one.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 1 OF 4 · WIDEN IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Before you pick, how many solutions?

1

Why write several solutions before you pick one?

2

How do you pick the winner?

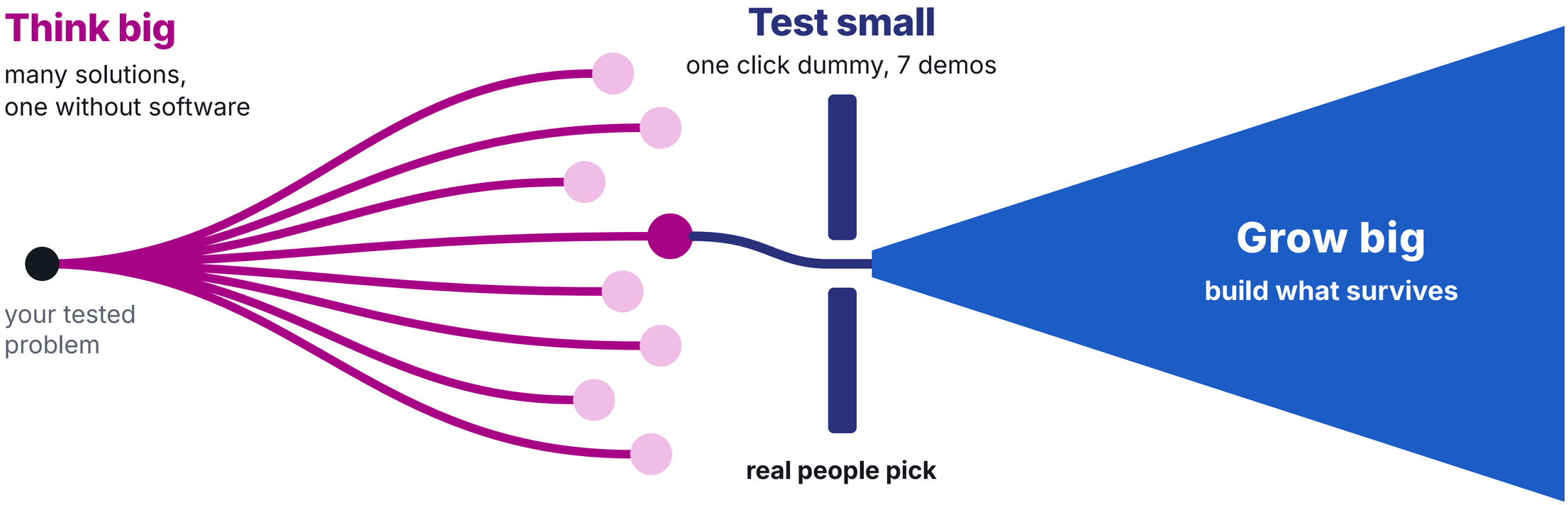
3

What if every solution falls under your line?

CORNERSTONE · FINDING IDEAS (M02)

Think big, test small, now for solutions

Same picture, same discipline, a new object

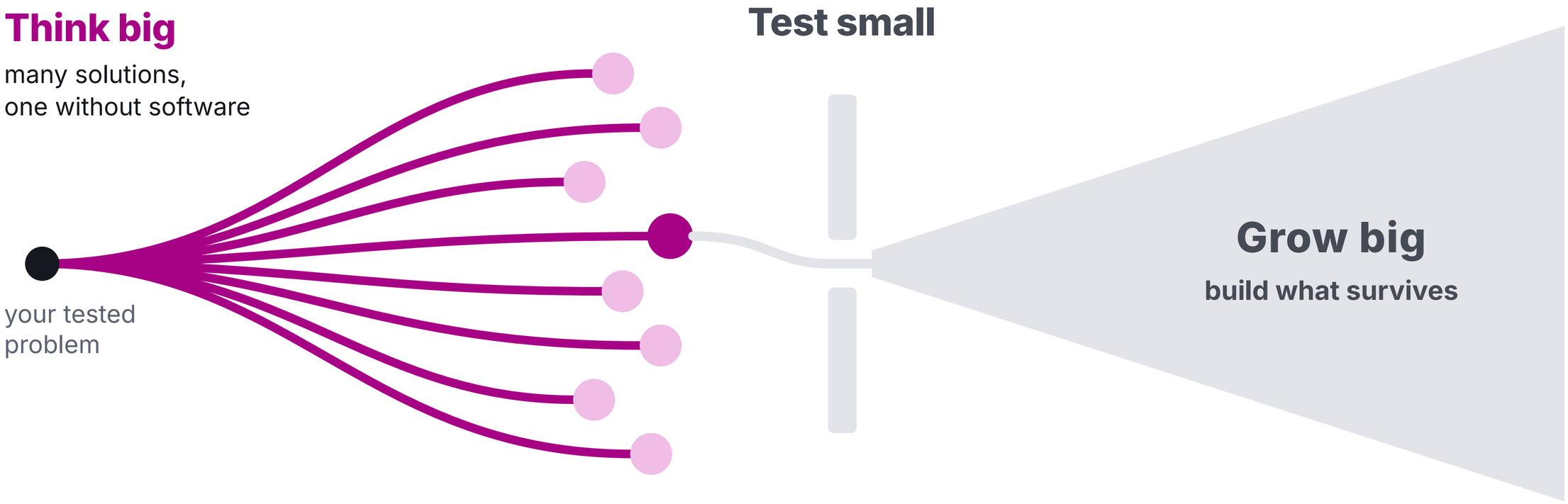


FRAMEWORK After Campbell, D. T. (1960). Blind variation and selective retention in creative thought. Psychological Review, 67(6).

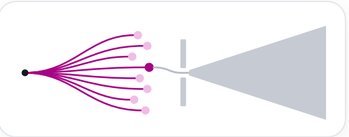
THINK BIG

Go wide before you go deep

Several solutions to one tested problem



FRAMEWORK After Campbell, D. T. (1960). Blind variation and selective retention in creative thought. Psychological Review, 67(6).



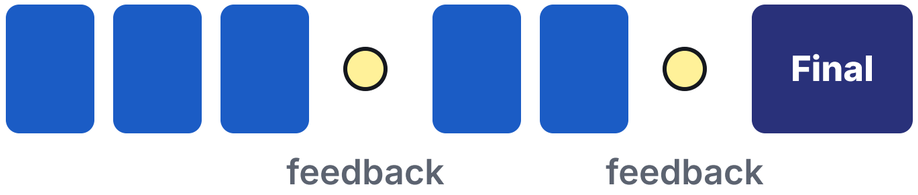
WHY IT MATTERS

Side by side beats one by one

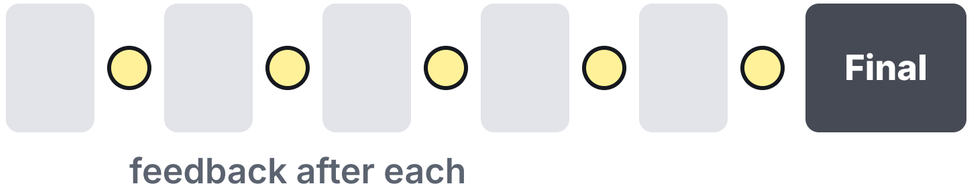
33 novice designers, live ads, 1.18 million impressions

Same time, same feedback, five prototypes

Parallel three side by side



Serial one after the other



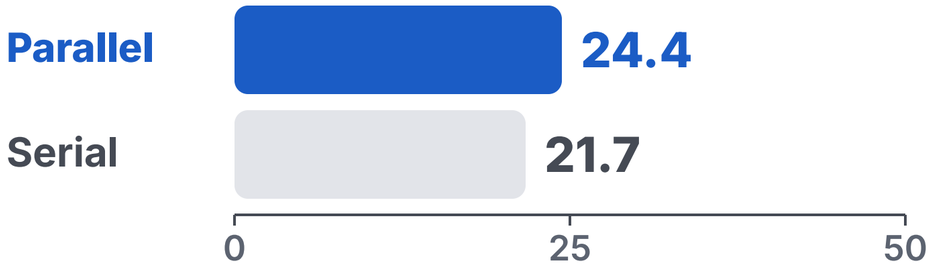
Clicks per million impressions

parallel +12%

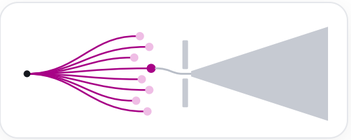


Expert rating, out of 50

parallel +12%

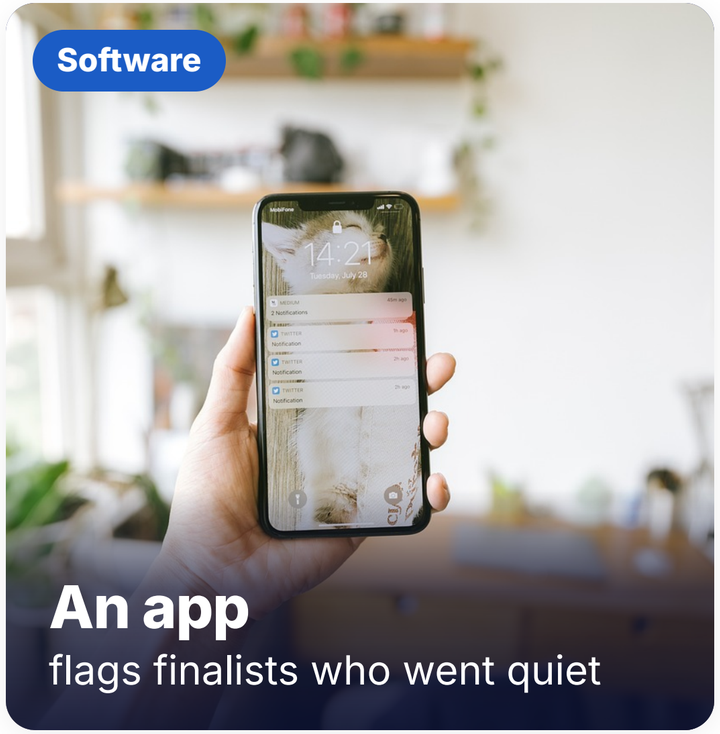


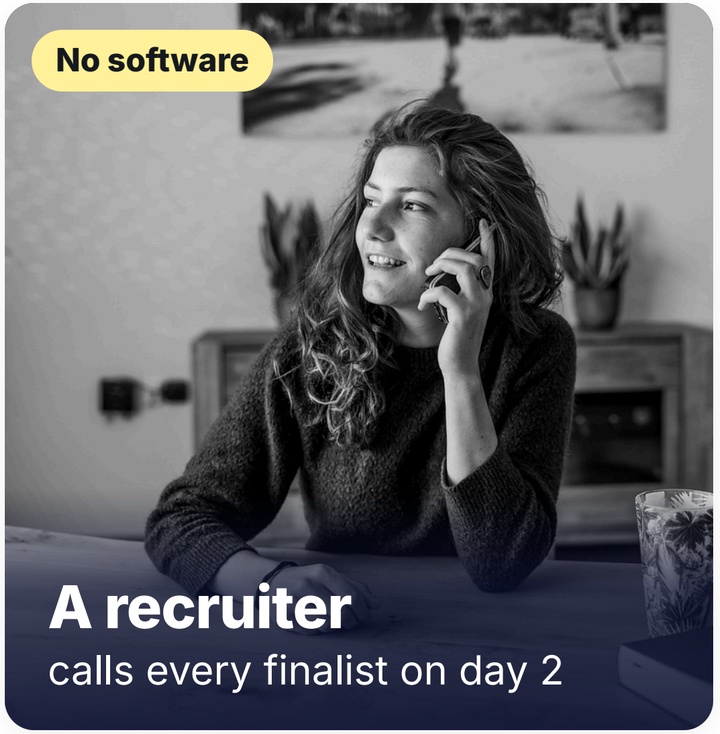
RESEARCH Dow, S. P., et al. (2010). Parallel prototyping leads to better design results, more divergence, and increased self-efficacy. *ACM TOCHI*, 17(4). Both differences significant.

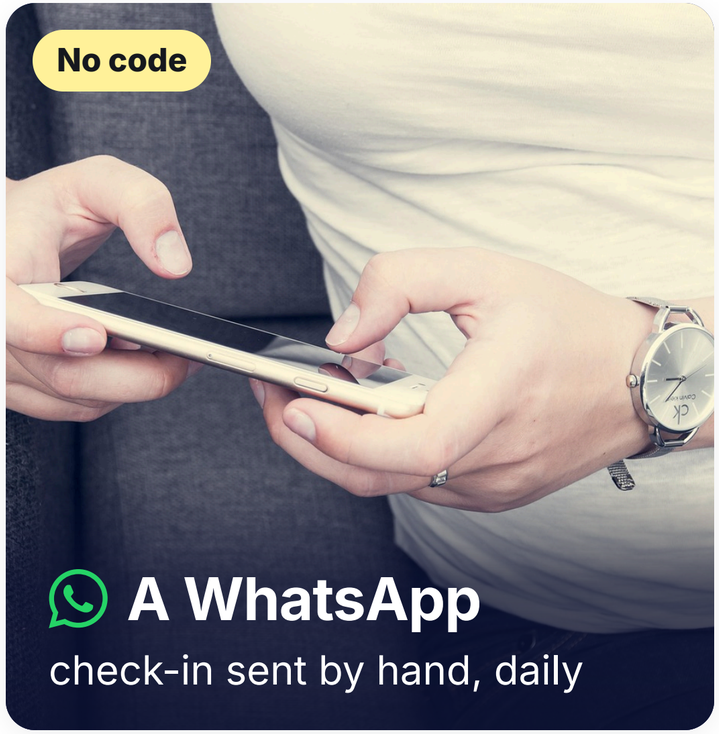


WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP

Three solutions, one without software

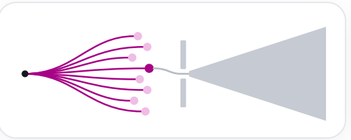






Today they use a spreadsheet and a Friday check, and lose finalists after a week

ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up recruiting venture, as in the Validating problems (M04) workshop. Photos: tranmautritam, VinzentWeinbeer, DariuszSankowski on Pixabay. Logos are trademarks of their owners.



HOW-TO · AI IDEATION · A SKILL, NOT A PROMPT

Use AI to go wide, never to decide

skills/go-wide/SKILL.md

Use when a tested problem needs solutions

1 Explore the painpoint. Look for counterintuitive problems nobody has paid attention to yet

2 Search for existing solutions. Summarize them

3 Brainstorm solutions that differ from all of them

Rule at least one without software. `Never rank them`

Good three that differ in kind. **Weak** three versions of one app

1. Write the skill once
2. Give it your notes
3. Fix the skill, not the output
4. **Keep three**

AI widens the list. Your segment picks.

ILLUSTRATIVE Skill and chat written for this course, the made-up recruiting team. Any current model works.

WITH YOUR AGENT

Use AI to go wide, never to decide

Your agent go-wide

Go wide on this problem. Finalists go quiet and recruiters notice too late.

sign-up-calls.txt

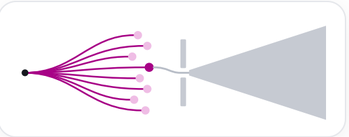
Three that differ in kind. An alert app, a recruiter who calls on day 2, a daily check-in by message. Not ranked, your segment does that.

Last time two were the same app. Add a rule to the skill.

Skill updated. Solutions must differ in who does the work.

Reply...

ILLUSTRATIVE Skill and chat written for this course, the made-up recruiting team. Any current model works.



NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

Write three solutions, one without software

Status quo — What do they use today, at what cost?

Solution A — The one you came in with

Solution B — One with no code at all

Ask AI — Three more you'd never think of

3:00

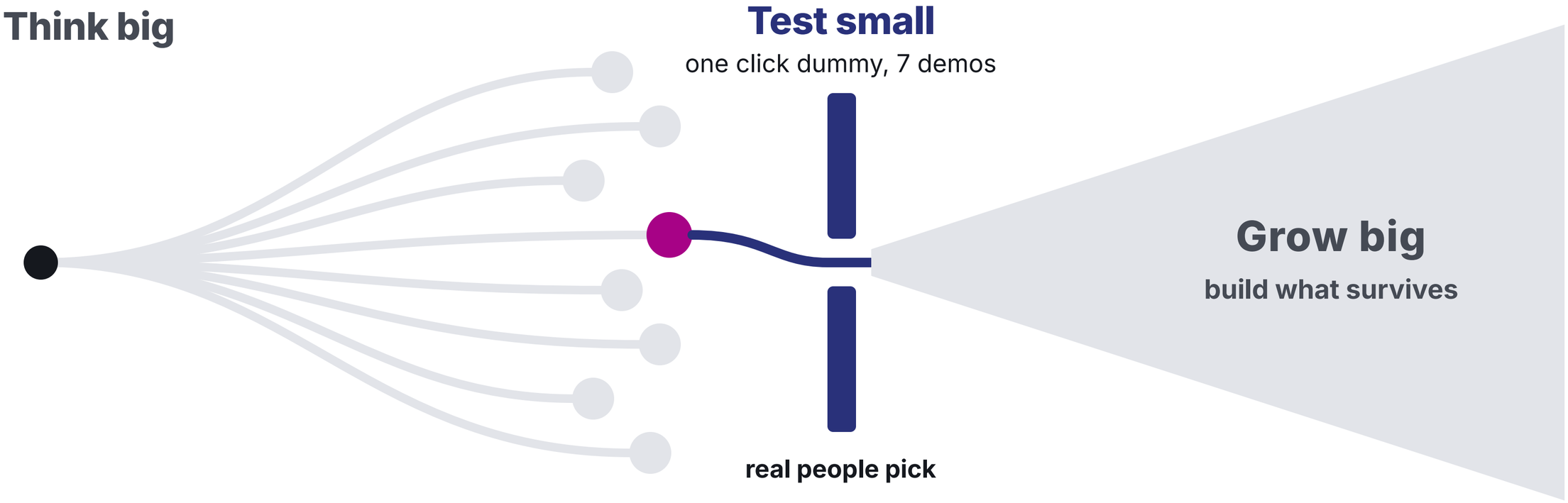
OUTPUT

Three solutions per founder

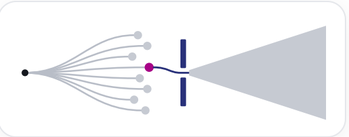
TEST SMALL

Converge by what people did

Not by what you like. Against a kill line set first

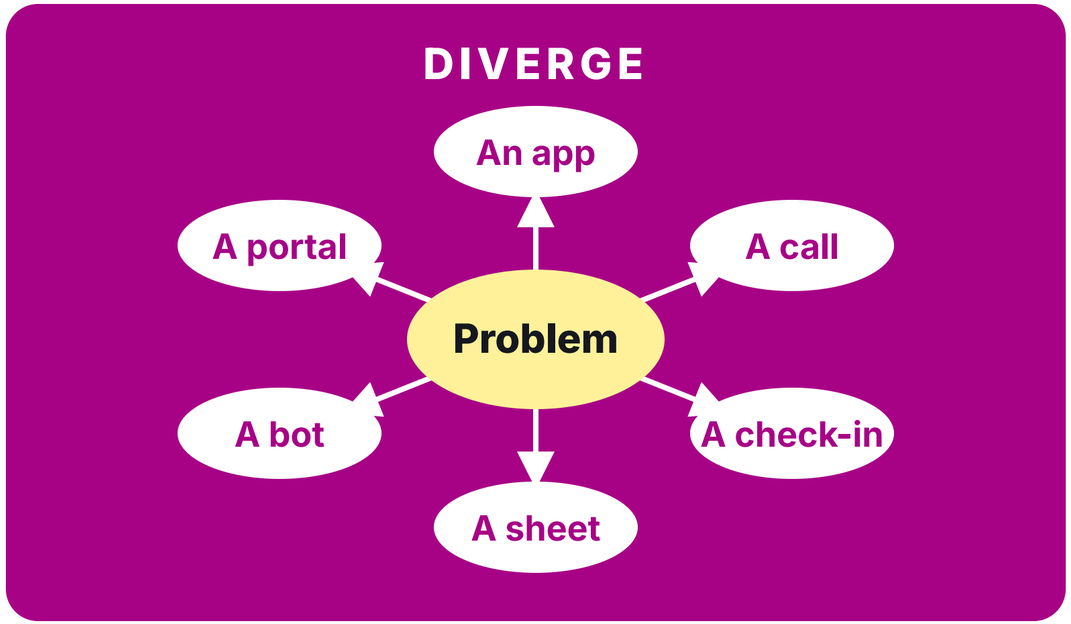


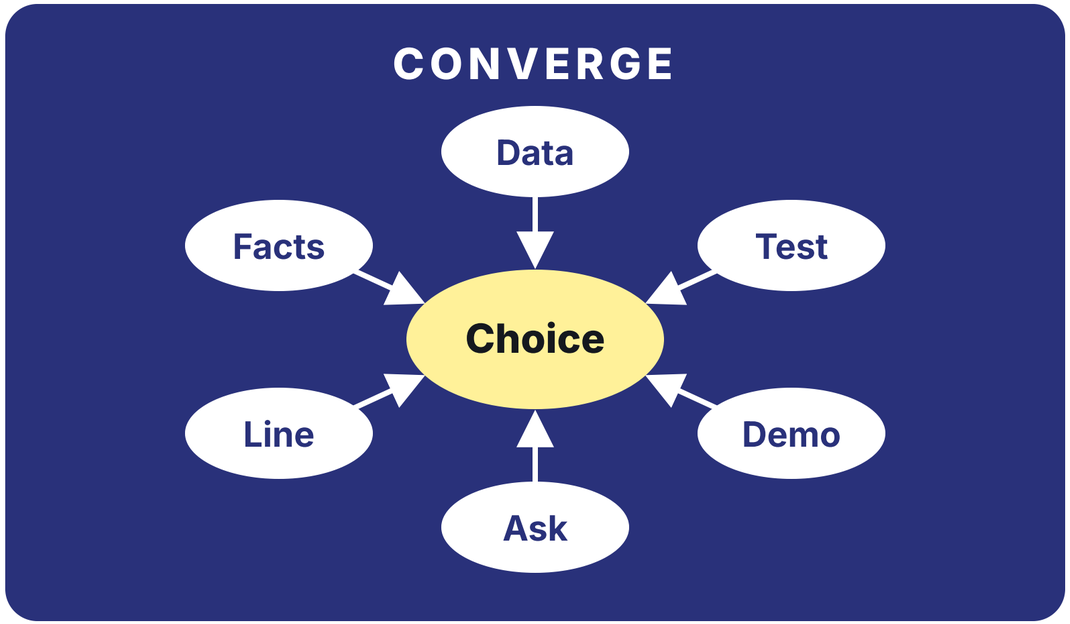
FRAMEWORK After Campbell, D. T. (1960). Blind variation and selective retention in creative thought. Psychological Review, 67(6).



DIVERGENCE VS. CONVERGENCE

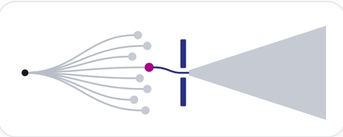
Diverge with ideas. Converge with data





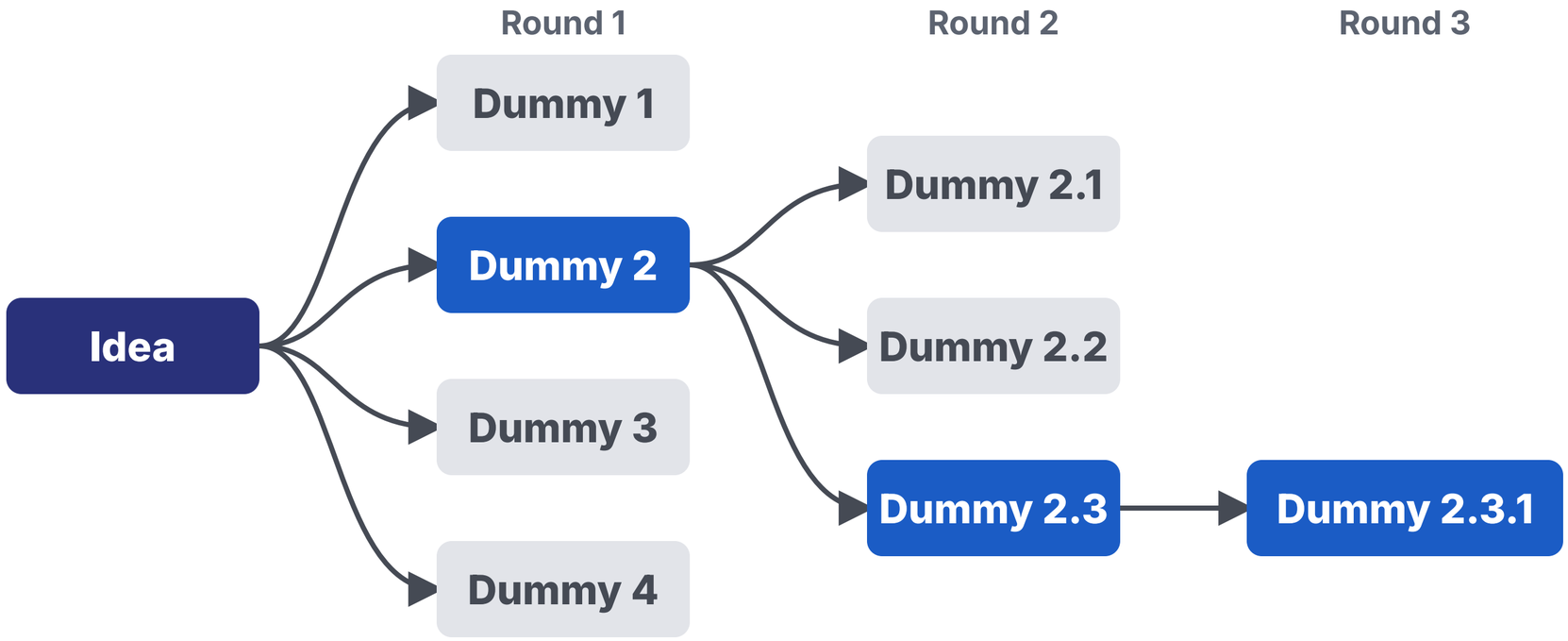
> RULE **Two modes, two toolboxes. Never in one meeting.**

ILLUSTRATIVE The six solutions on the left are the made-up recruiting venture's.



EVOLUTIONARY PROTOTYPING

One dummy per founder. The line picks the winner



Every founder builds 1 dummy in 4 hours

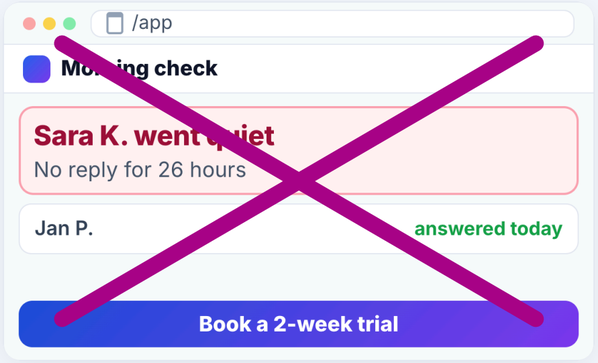
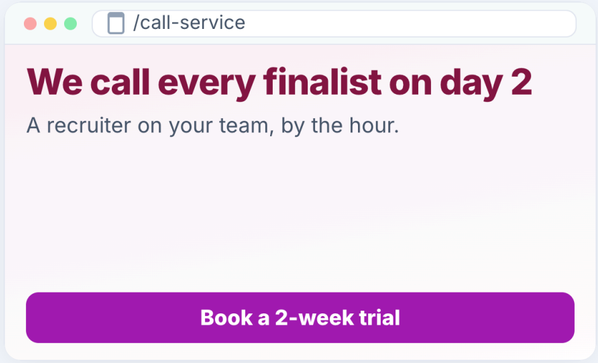
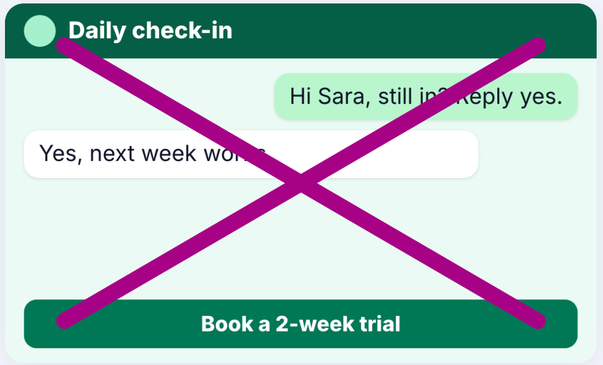
Set the line first

7 demos each, then decide

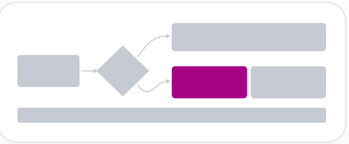
BUILD TO THROW AWAY

Your first dummies are made to be thrown away

Done is better than perfect

Build			
Measure	7 demos	7 demos	7 demos
Learn	Bin	Keep, next round	Bin

ILLUSTRATIVE Three dummies of the made-up recruiting team, screens prototyped for this course.



PIVOTING · TYPE 1

A type 1 pivot changes the solution

Same problem. App to product, B2B to B2C, sale to subscription

Problem space

Finalists go quiet

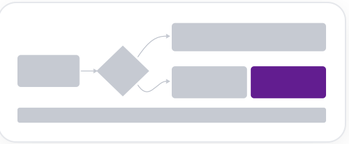
stays the same

Solution space

~~An app~~

A recruiter who calls

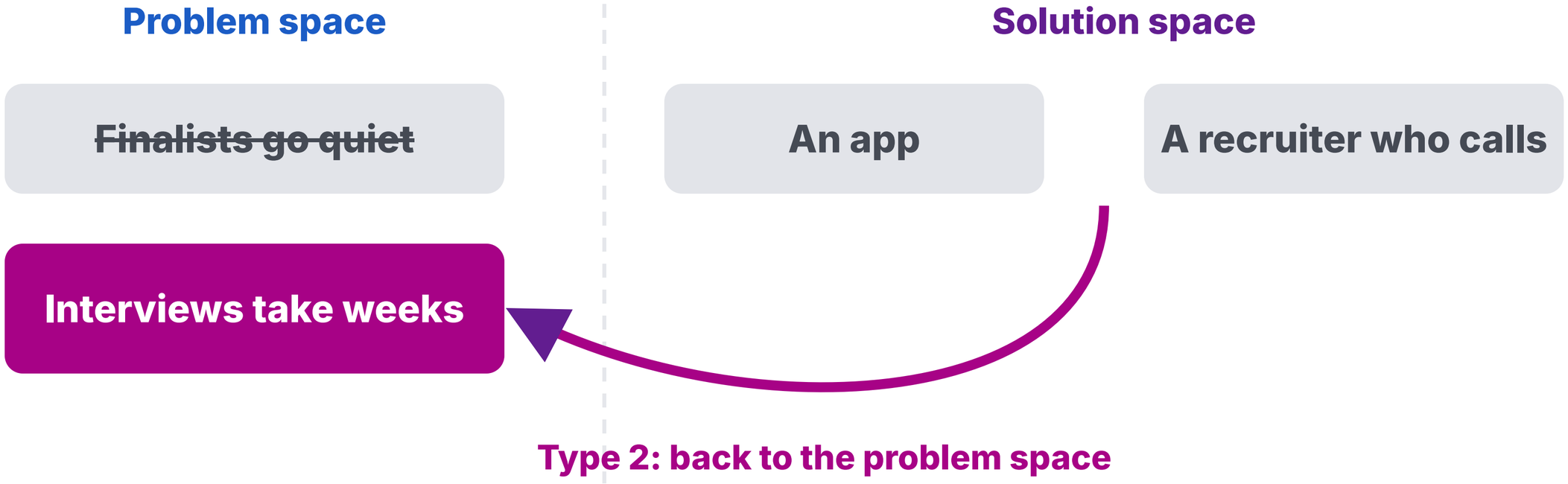
Type 1: another solution to the same problem



PIVOTING · TYPE 2

A type 2 pivot goes back to the problem

A new problem space and a clean cut. Slow and hard on the team



INPUT 1 OF 4 · WIDEN IT · THE ANSWERS

Widen it: several solutions, the line picks

1

Why write several solutions before you pick one?

Side by side beats one by one, and the best may need no software

2

How do you pick the winner?

By what people did with each, against a line set first, not by what you like

3

What if every solution falls under your line?

You pivot. Type 1 tries another solution, type 2 goes back to the problem

INPUT 2 OF 4 · CHAPTER 4 OF 9

Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing

Say in under ten words why your segment would switch, and prove it.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 2 OF 4 · SHARPEN IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Why would they switch?

1

What is a value proposition?

2

Who is it for?

3

How much better must it be?

VALUE PROPOSITION

A value proposition matches an offer to a need



CORE PRINCIPLE

Build something that is

10 times better

than what your users have now.

Not better than a competitor's feature list.

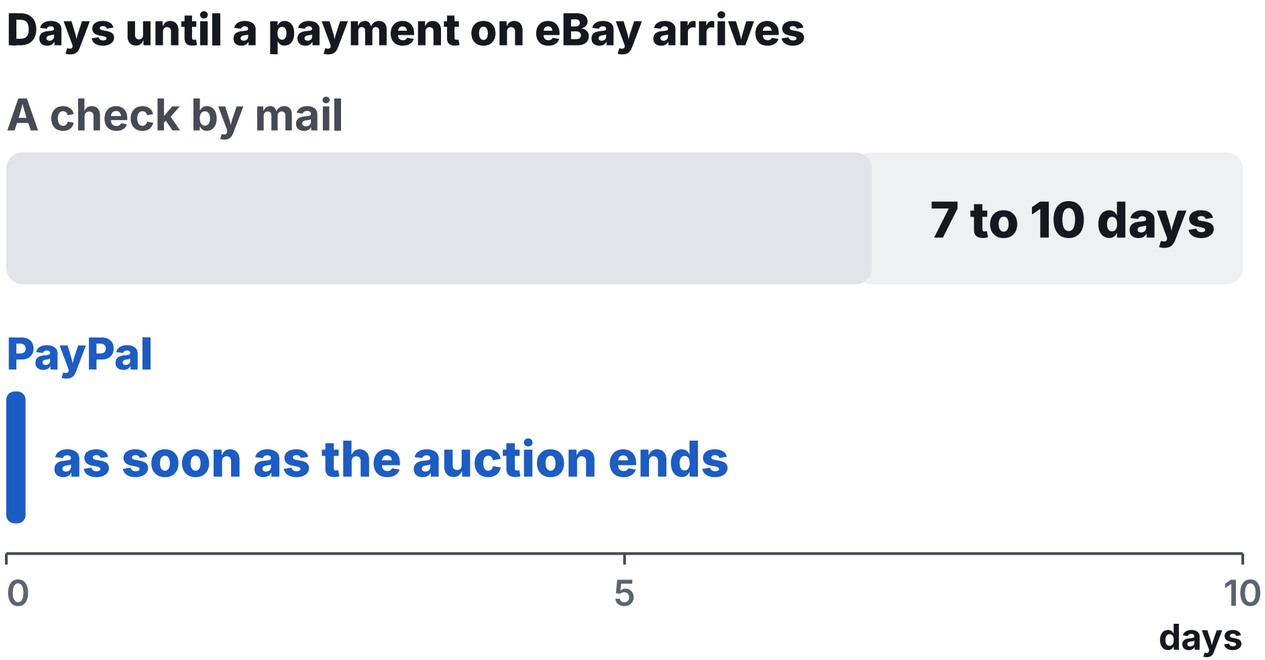
FRAMEWORK The 10x rule of thumb: Reid Hoffman in Peter Thiel's CS183 class (Masters, 2012).

THE 10X RULE · THE AUTHOR'S EXAMPLE

PayPal was 10 times better than a check

On eBay, one dimension, speed. Sellers also knew the funds were good



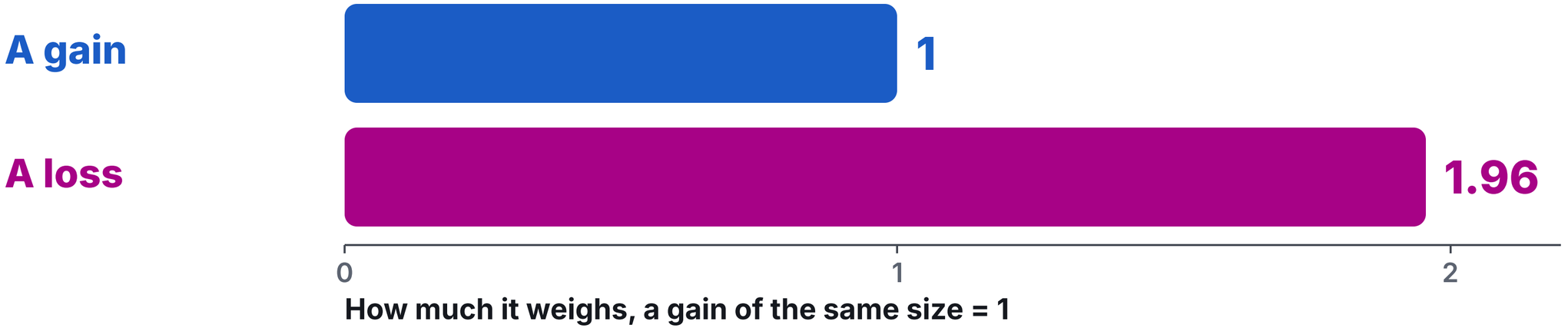


FRAMEWORK Thiel, P., & Masters, B. (2014). *Zero to One*. Crown Business.
Photo: 5317367 on Pixabay. Logos are trademarks of their owners.

WHY TEN TIMES

A loss weighs about twice as much as a gain

Mean of 607 estimates from 150 articles, 1992 to 2017. Bars to scale



Switching means losing your habit, your data, your workaround.

Gourville calls the gap a 9x mismatch. Practitioners say 10x (Hoffman).

RESEARCH Brown, A. L., Imai, T., Vieider, F. M., & Camerer, C. F. (2024). Meta-analysis of empirical estimates of loss aversion. *Journal of Economic Literature*, 62(2). Samuelson & Zeckhauser (1988). Gourville (2006).

VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS

Four boxes, one segment

Painpoint · what problem do you address?

Value proposition

your solution to the painpoint

One customer segment

who suffers most, who pays

Competition · what else addresses this pain?

VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS · THE AUTHOR'S EXAMPLE

iPod: a thousand songs in your pocket

The music player Osterwalder uses to explain his canvas



Painpoint

Copying songs back and forth, because storage is tiny

Value proposition

A thousand songs in a pocket

Customer segment

People who listen to music on the go

Competition

Earlier players with tiny storage

FRAMEWORK Osterwalder, A. (2012). The Customer Value Map v.0.8. Strategyzer. In the course's four boxes. Competition is our reading. Photo: mikefoster on Pixabay. Logos are trademarks of their owners.

CUSTOMER SEGMENT

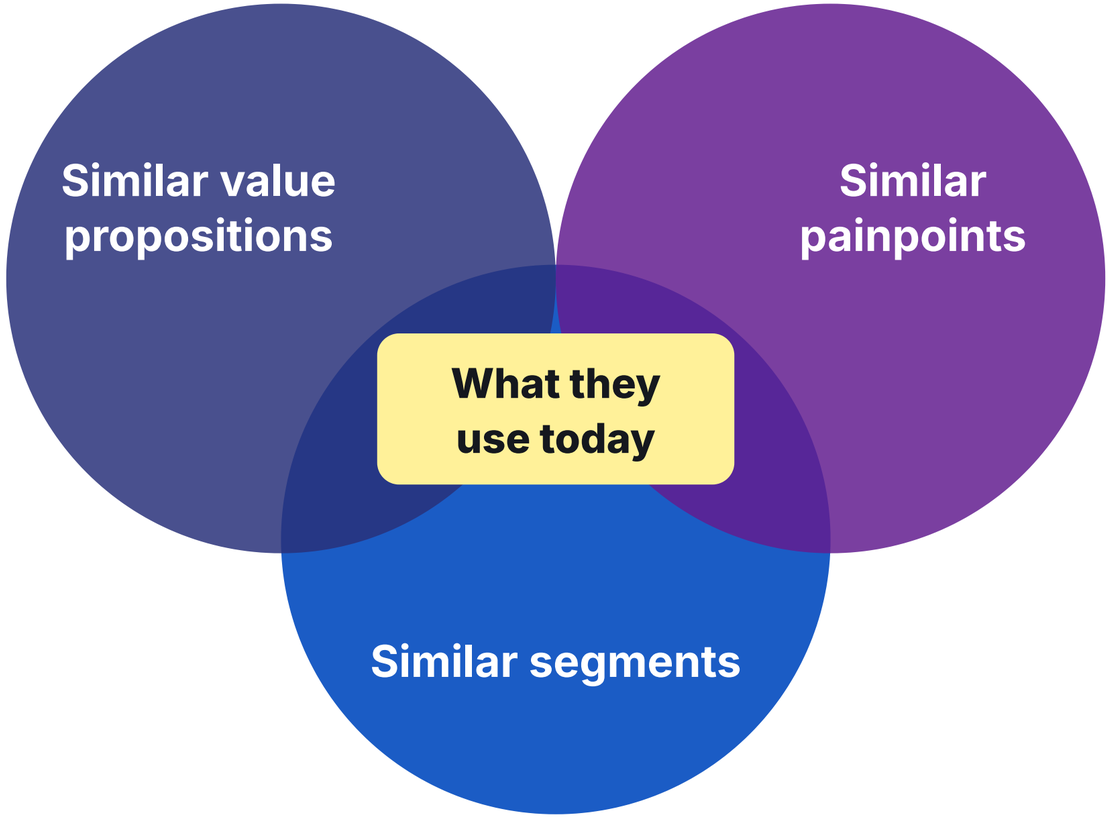
Start where suffering meets willingness to pay



ILLUSTRATIVE In the made-up recruiting venture the recruiter suffers, the head of talent pays. Photos: StartupStockPhotos, u_c48rf6ybx8 on Pixabay.

COMPETITION

Your real competitor is what they use today



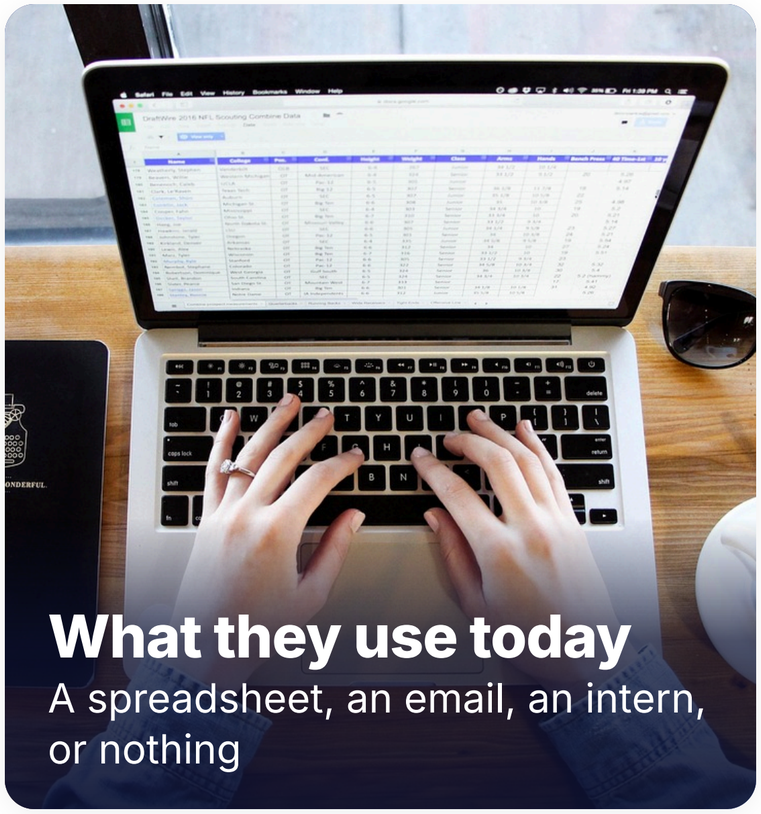


Photo: Pexels on Pixabay.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP · NOTHING BY HAND

Your calls fill the four boxes. Your agent types

Painpoint

Finalists go quiet, and we notice at the Friday check · heard from Lena, Sam, Ayla

Value proposition

Know within an hour that a finalist went quiet · heard from 4

Customer segment

In-house recruiters, the head of talent pays · assumed, ask Sam

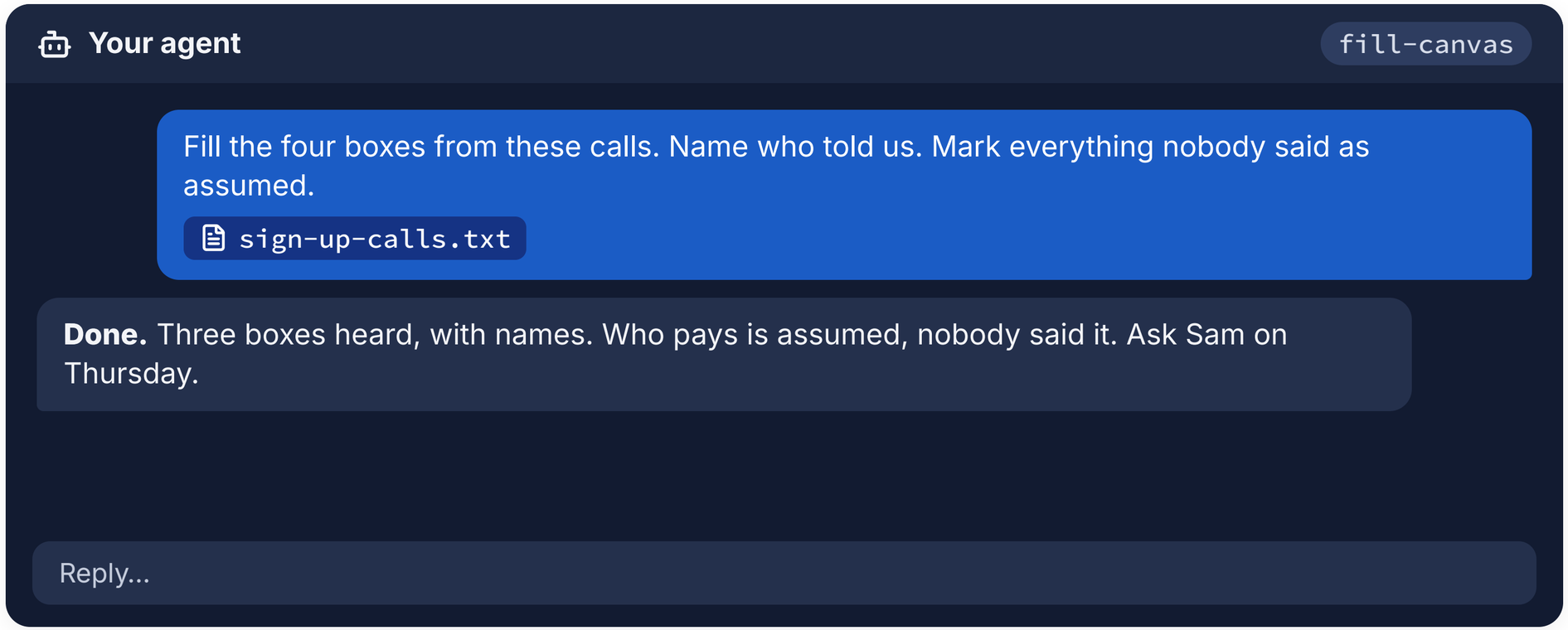
Competition

A spreadsheet and a Friday check · heard from Lena, Ayla

ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up recruiting venture, names made up. Canvas and chat written for this course.

WITH YOUR AGENT

Your calls fill the four boxes. Your agent types

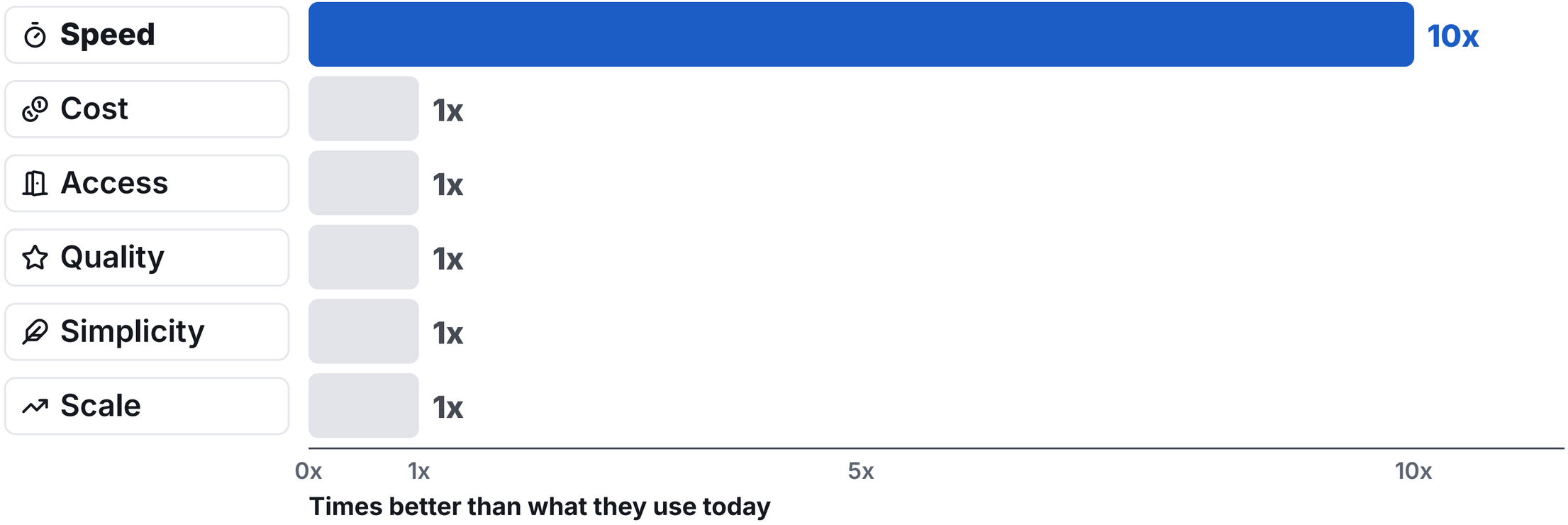


ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up recruiting venture, names made up. Canvas and chat written for this course.

THE 10X TEST

Pick one dimension. Be 10 times better there

Under 10 words. 10x on everything is 1x on everything



FRAMEWORK Course framework 07, 10x Value Prop Test, gates 1 and 2. Bars illustrative, one dimension against the status quo.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP

An hour, not a week

Bars drawn to scale

Today: spreadsheet, Friday check

1 week = 40 working hours

With the alert



Working hours until the recruiter knows a finalist went quiet

"Know within an hour that a finalist went quiet."

Speed · proof: heard from 4 recruiters, not yet measured

ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up recruiting venture. A week counted as 40 working hours.

NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

Write your 10x line

Segment — One segment, not everybody

Status quo — What they use today

Dimension — Speed, cost, access, quality …

10x line — Under 10 words

Proof — Heard, measured or assumed?

3:00

OUTPUT

One 10x line per solution

INPUT 2 OF 4 · SHARPEN IT · THE ANSWERS

Sharpen it: one segment, one dimension, 10x

1

What is a value proposition?

An offer matched to a need, said in under ten words and backed by what you heard or measured

2

Who is it for?

One segment, where suffering meets willingness to pay, against what they use today

3

How much better must it be?

Ten times better on one dimension, because a loss weighs about twice a gain

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CHAPTER 5 OF 9

Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand

Cut your solution to the one feature that delivers its 10x, and fake the rest.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 ~~Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing~~

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CUT IT · THREE QUESTIONS

How little must you build?

1

What goes into your first dummy?

2

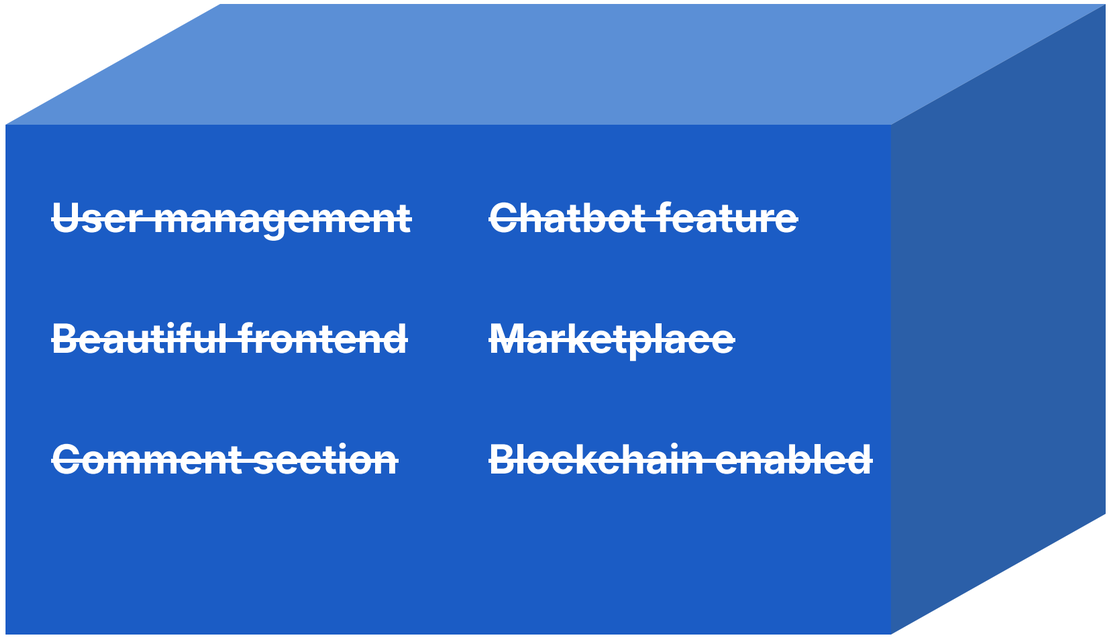
What may stay fake behind it?

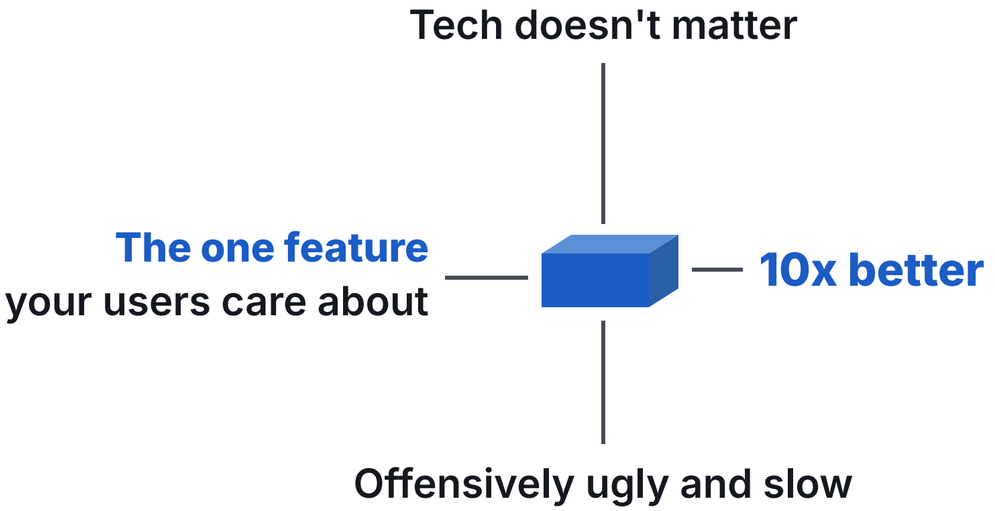
3

When is it an MVP?

YOUR PROTOTYPE

Your first dummy is smaller than you think

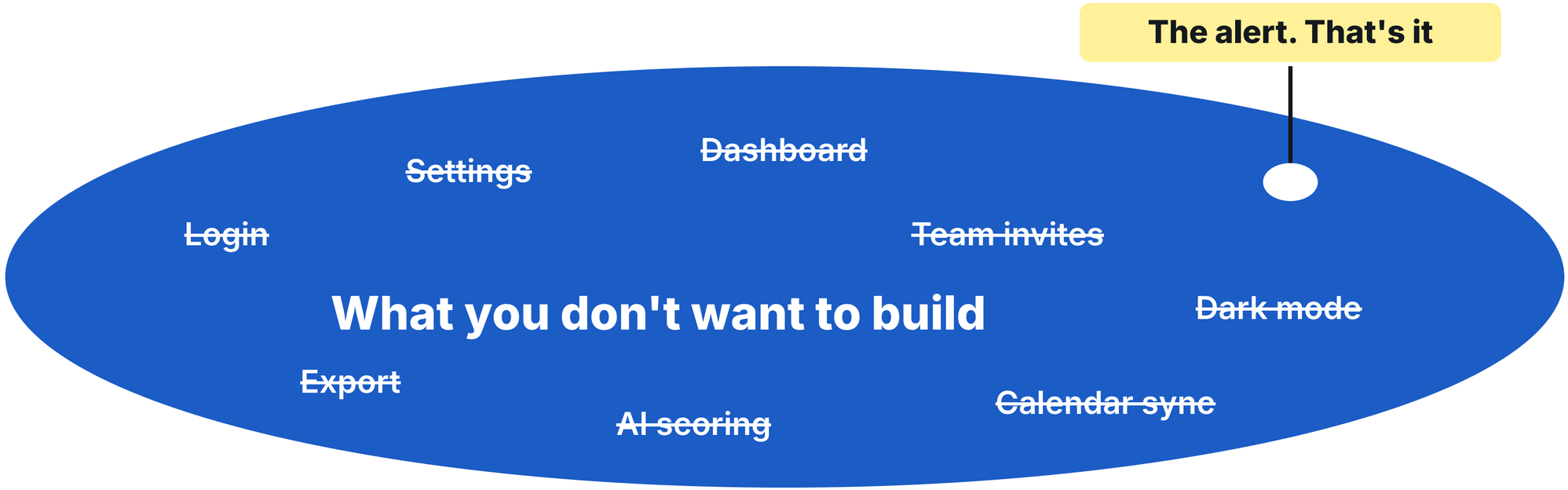




PREVIOUSLY · FINDING IDEAS (M02)

Decide what you won't build

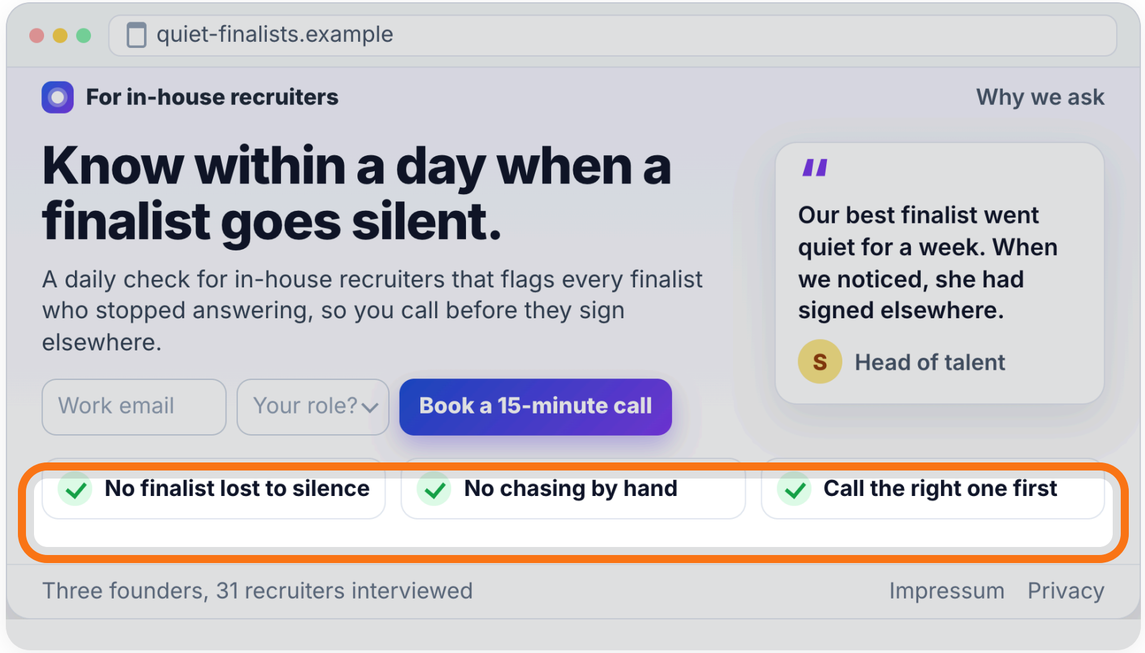
Strong constraints leave few implementations



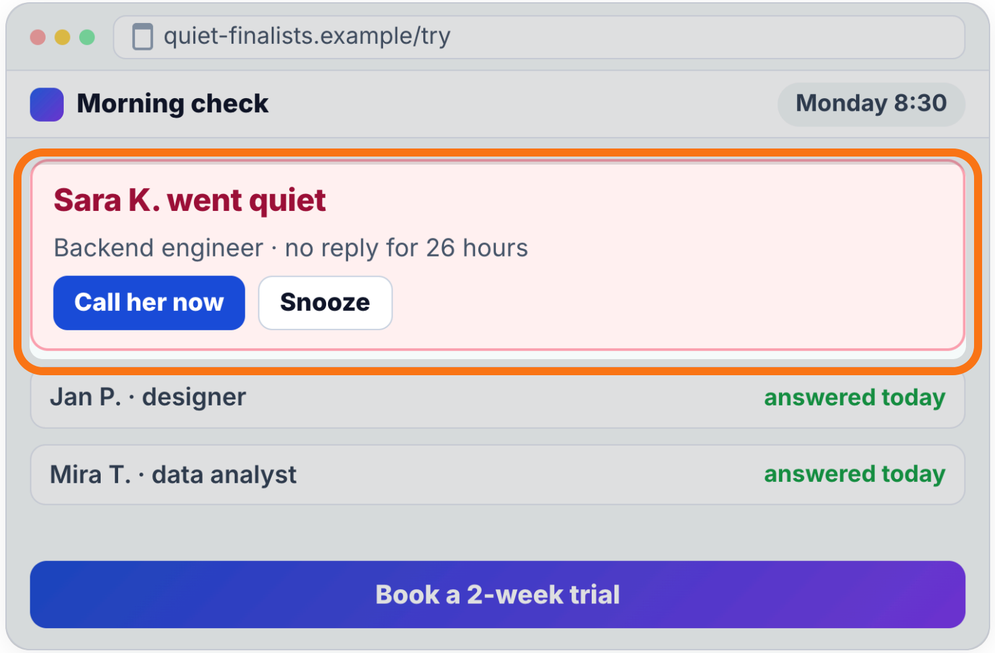
PAGE VS. DUMMY

The page names benefits. The dummy builds one

Your page names the benefits



Your dummy builds the one that is 10x



ILLUSTRATIVE Both screens prototyped for this course, the made-up recruiting team of the workshop.

SPEED MATTERS

One iteration should not take more than

4 hours

Don't lie!!!
Counting only the time you were "really" working is lying.

TECH SOLUTION & BUSINESS SOLUTION

Solve the business before the tech



BUSINESS SOLUTION

Does the market need it?

What will it pay?

Solve this first.

It sets your tech constraints.

TECH SOLUTION

Can we deliver it at scale?

Reliably, on a budget?

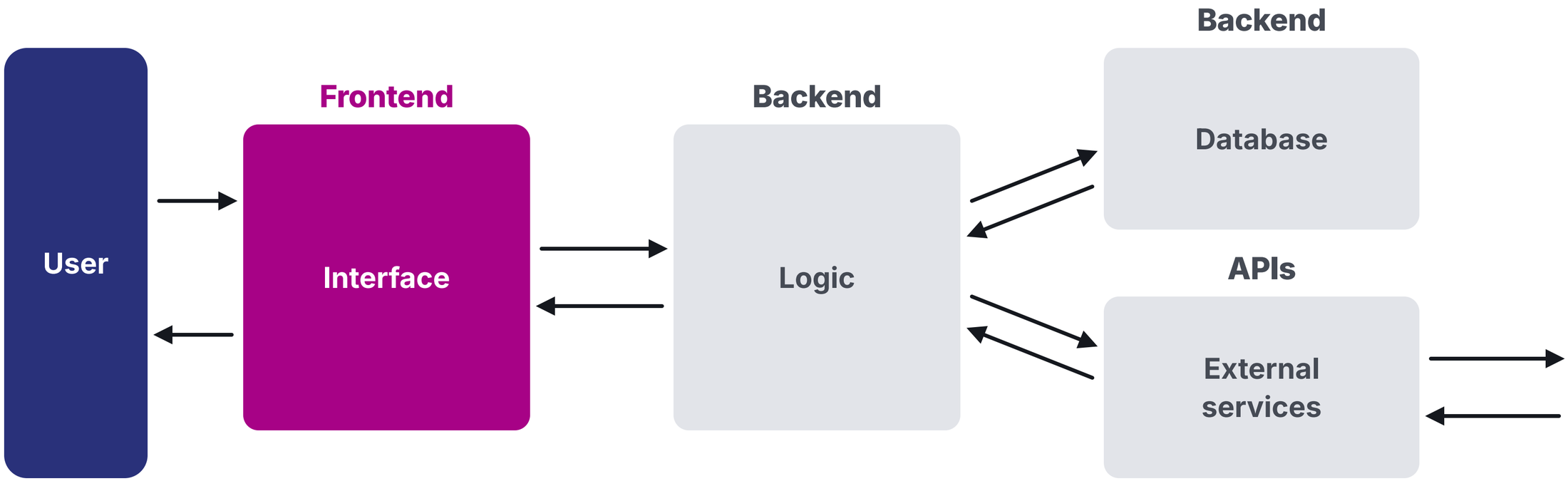
Must fit the business.

The simplest one wins.

Photo: PublicDomainPictures on Pixabay.

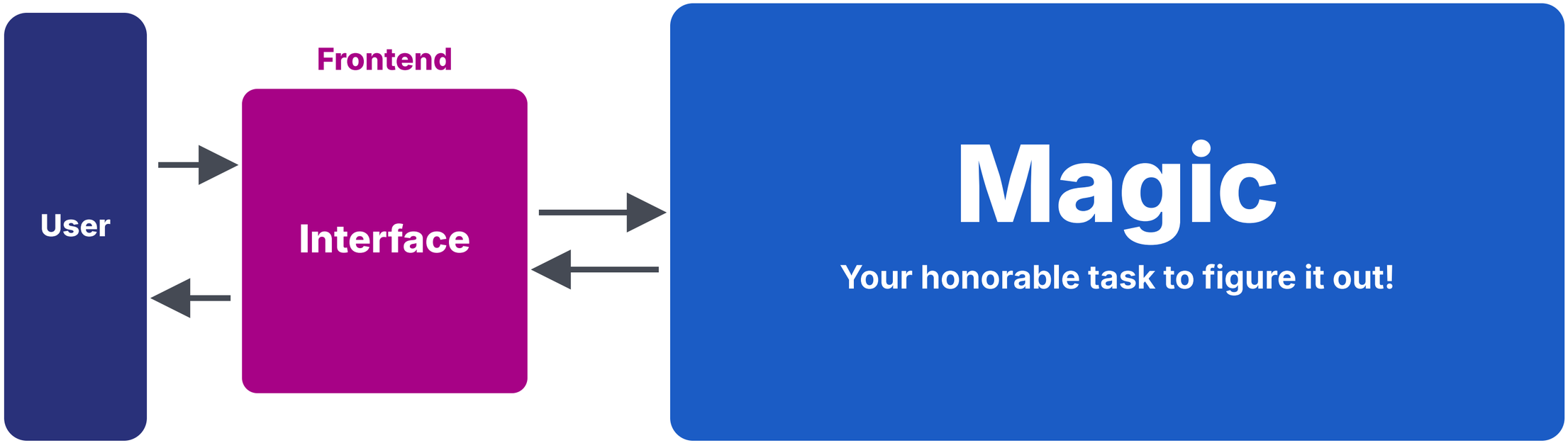
THINK INTERFACE FIRST

Every app is an interface on top of a lot of work



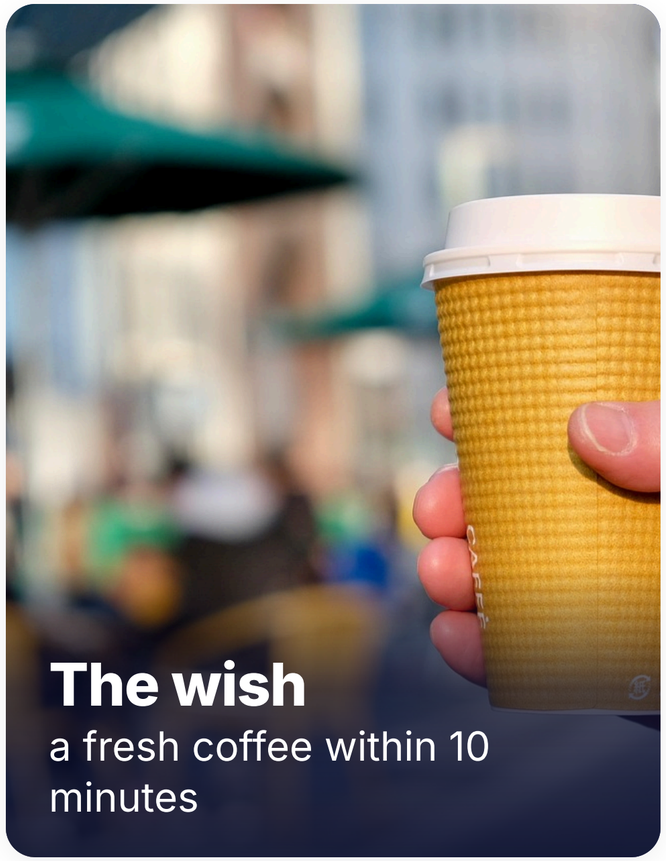
SMOKE AND MIRRORS

If anything behind it worked, would they love it?



SMOKE AND MIRRORS

Fake the magic. Test the wish



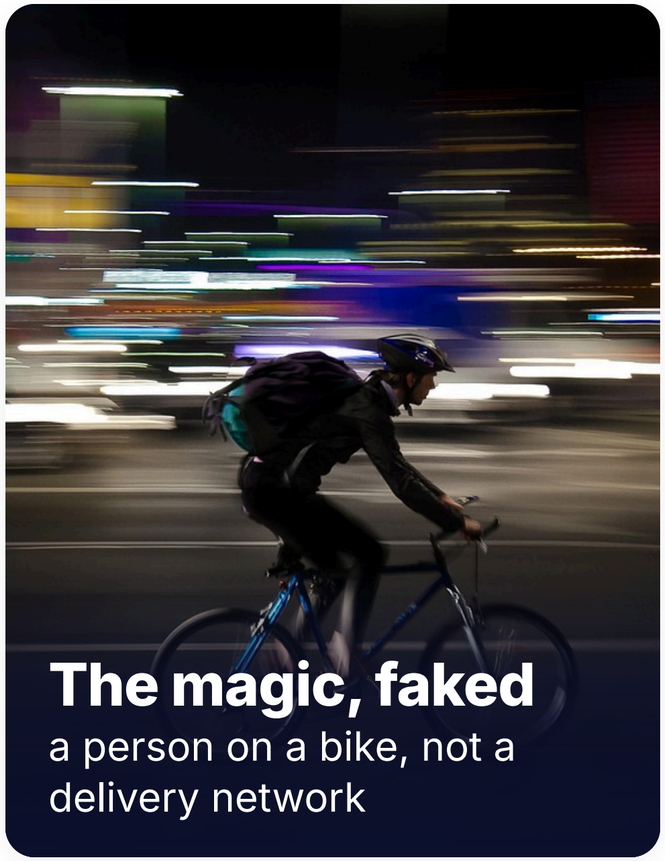
→

The interface

Coffee now

one button, nothing else

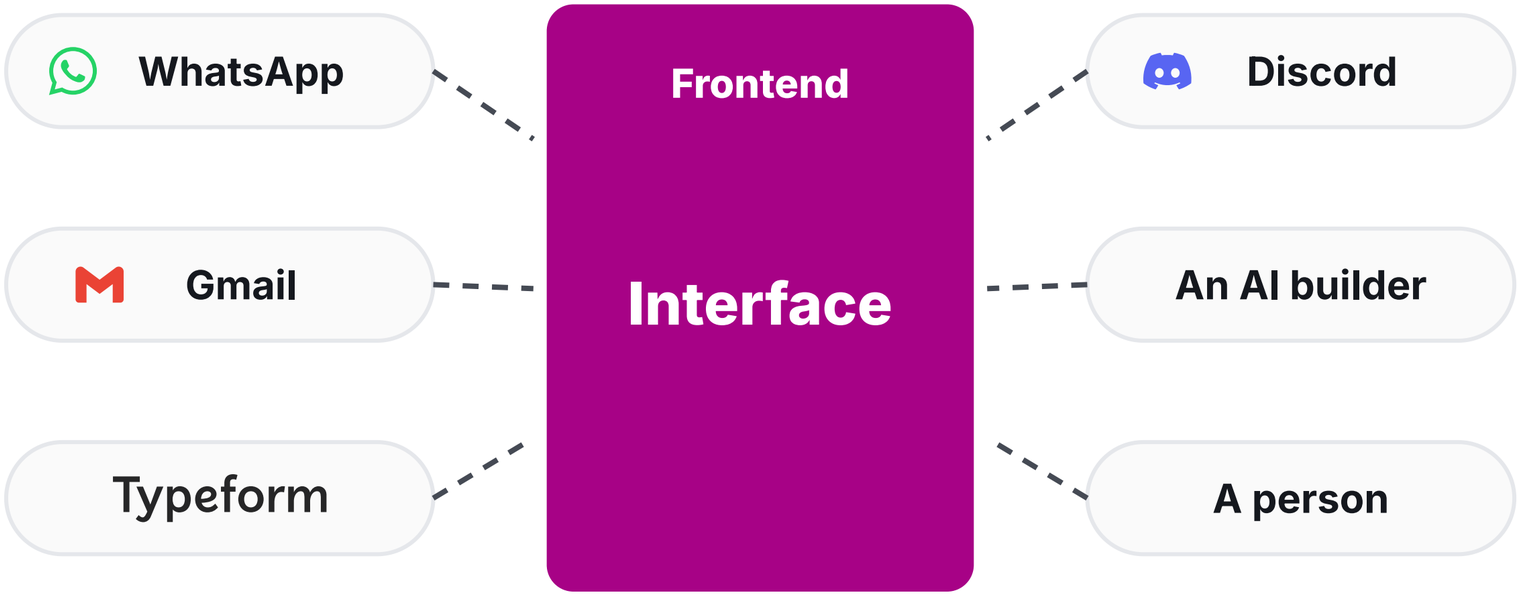
→



ILLUSTRATIVE A made-up coffee venture. Photos: t_watanabe, ClickerHappy on Pixabay.

SMOKE AND MIRRORS

Customers don't care HOW you do it!





RESEARCH · WIZARD OF OZ · THE FIRST EXAMPLE

Behind the curtain, a person plays the computer

A "listening typewriter" in 1983, before speech recognition worked







Some versions matched or beat handwriting and dictation, on first use

RESEARCH Gould, Conti & Hovanyecz (1983). Composing letters with a simulated listening typewriter. *CACM*, 26(4). Photos: janeb13, Wounds_and_Cracks, by_mema on Pixabay.

MVP. The smallest thing that can trigger validation (a wallet opening).

"If it can't be paid for, it's not viable — it's minimal and useless." Course Glossary

WORKED EXAMPLE · MADE UP

One alert, sent by hand, is an MVP

ONE FEATURE

The alert when a finalist goes quiet

INTERFACE

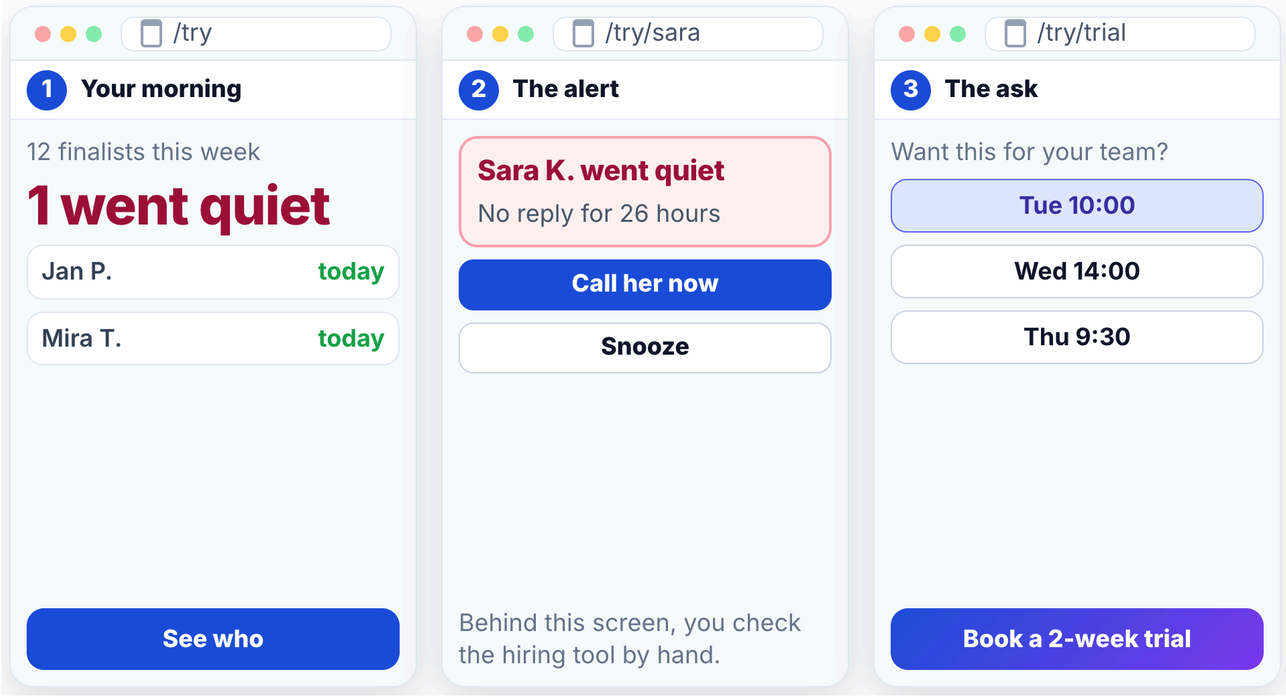
Three screens, the last one asks

MANUAL

You check the hiring tool by hand every hour and send the alert

OFFER

A 2-week trial for one team, then a monthly price



ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up recruiting venture, as in the workshop. Screens prototyped for this course.

NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 3 MINUTES

Cut to one feature. Split real from manual

One feature The one that is 10x

Interface What the screen must show

Manual What you do by hand behind it

Offer What it would cost them

3:00

OUTPUT

Your MVP in one sentence

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CUT IT · THE ANSWERS

Cut it: one feature, the magic by hand

1

What goes into your first dummy?

The one feature that delivers your 10x, and a list of what you won't build

2

What may stay fake behind it?

Everything behind the interface. A person can play the computer

3

When is it an MVP?

When it is the smallest offer someone in your segment could pay for

INPUT 4 OF 4 · CHAPTER 6 OF 9

Show it: a click dummy people try

Build a click dummy in hours, not weeks, and show it to people from your segment.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 ~~Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing~~

05 ~~Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand~~

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

INPUT 4 OF 4 · SHOW IT · THREE QUESTIONS

How do people try it?

1

How fast can you build a click dummy?

2

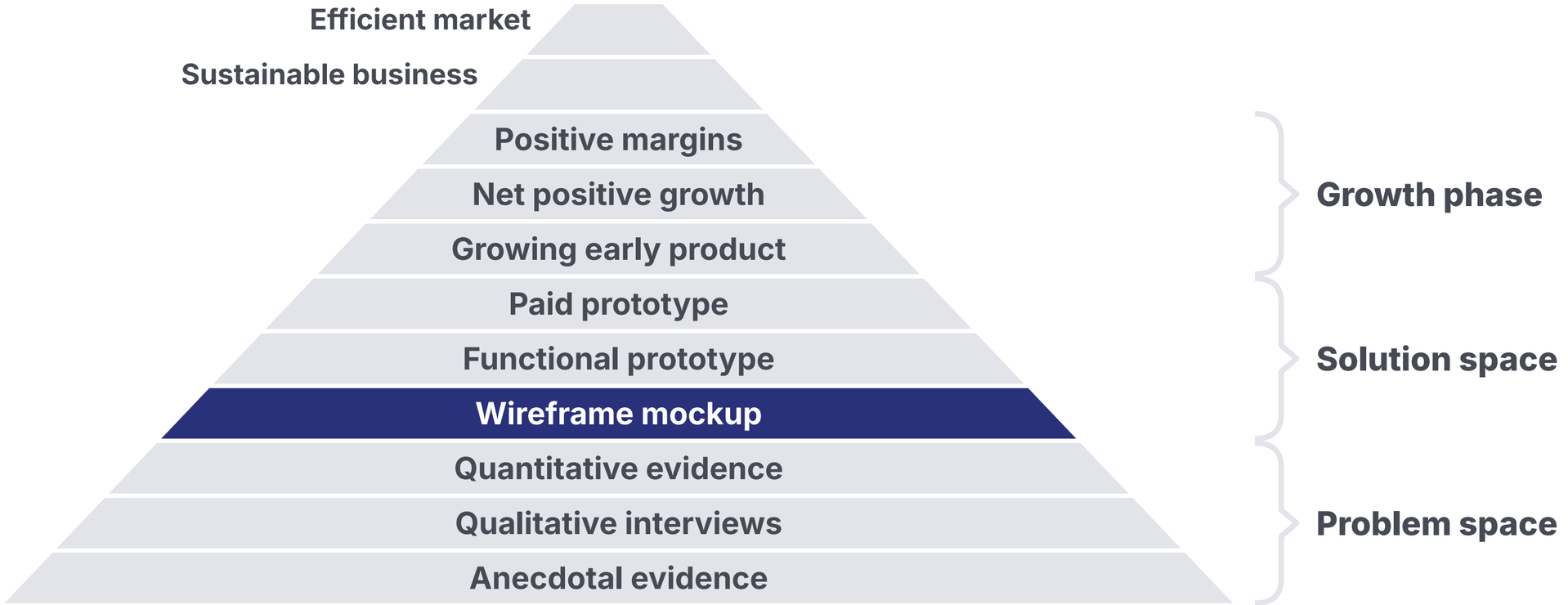
How do you show it?

3

What counts as a result?

THE VERY FIRST MOCK-UP

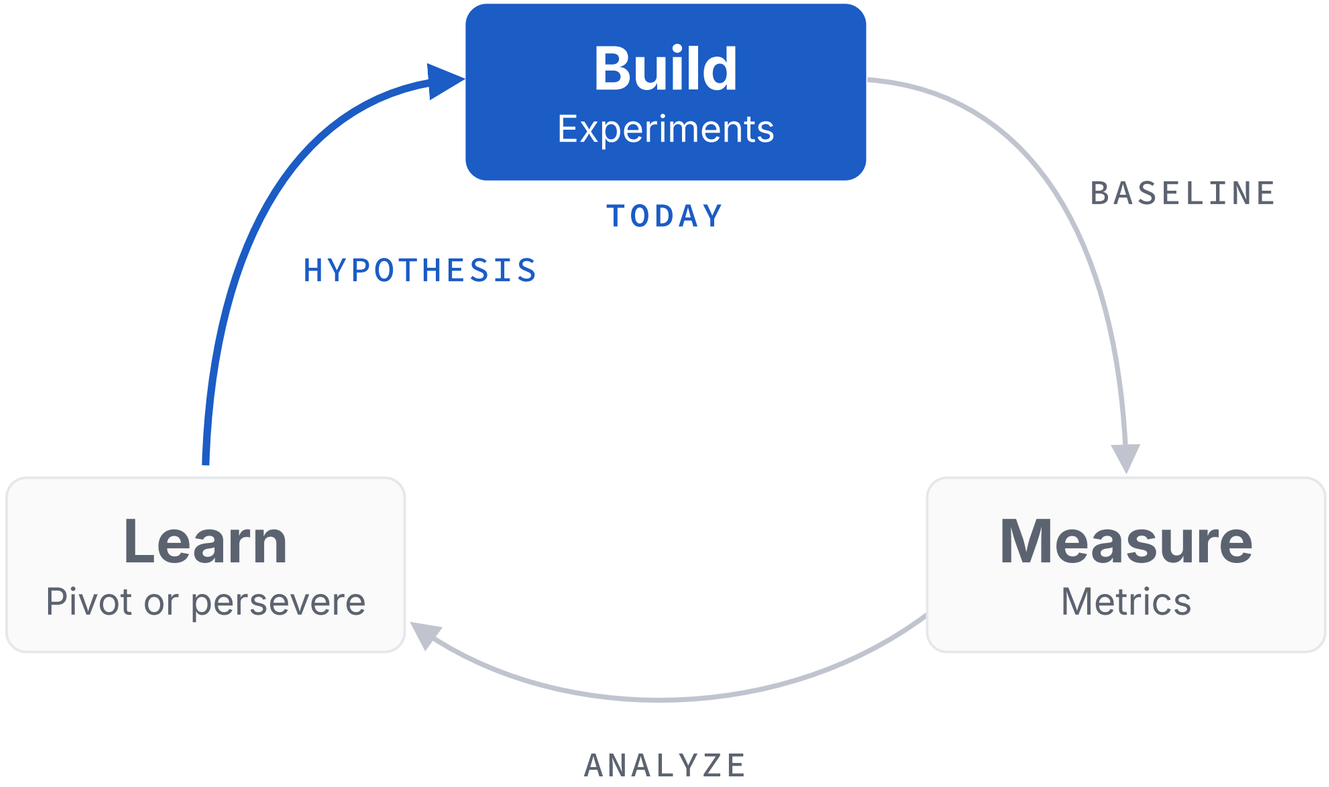
A click dummy is the mock-up. Signal, not proof



BUILD-MEASURE-LEARN

AI tilts the tide towards less engineering

A quarter of Y **YC**'s Winter 2025 founders said over 95% of their code was AI-written

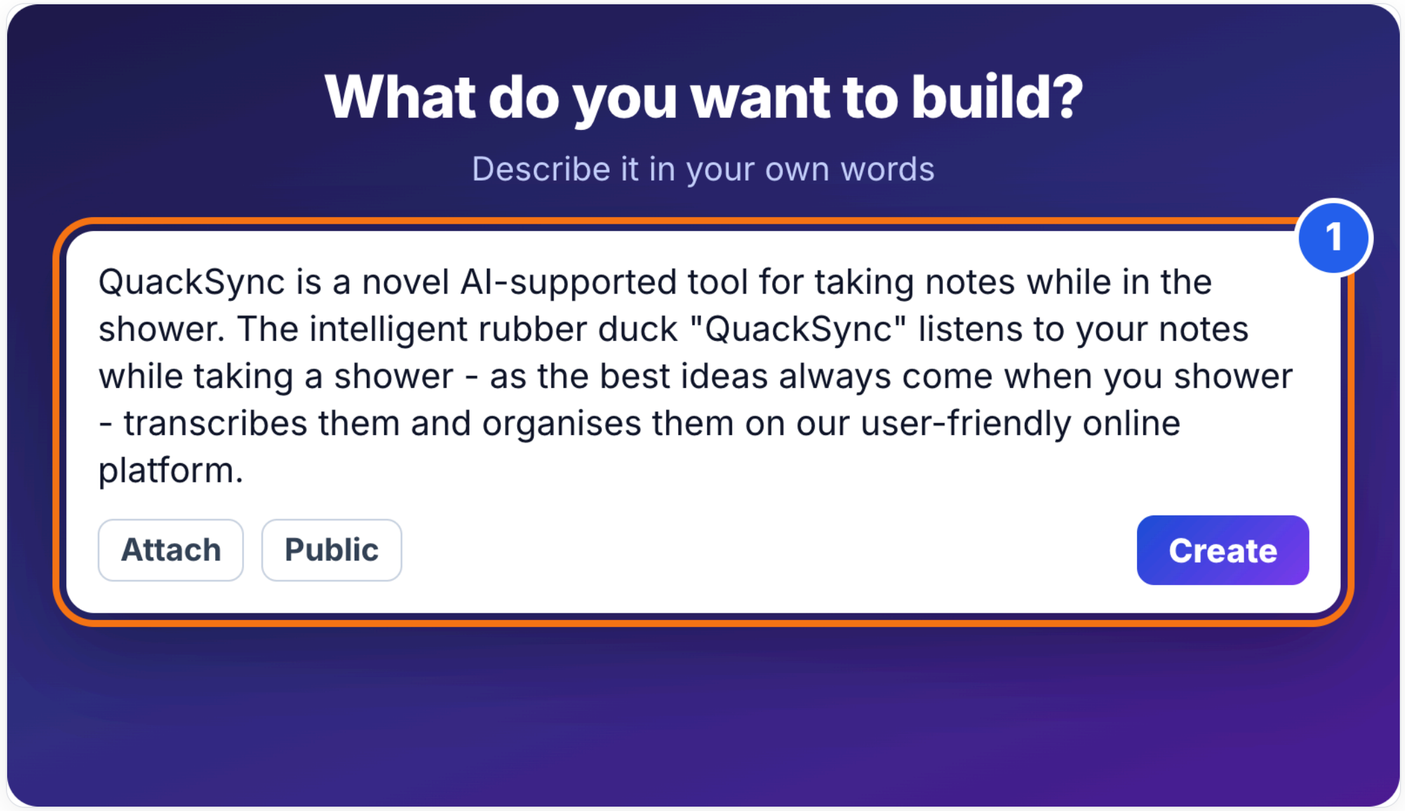


> BUILD **Building is no longer the bottleneck. Measuring and learning is.**

YC Friedman, J., on Y Combinator's Lightcone (2025, 5 March), founders' own estimates. Tan, G. (2025, 5 March), post on X. Build times and the QuackSync run in this chapter. Logos are trademarks of their owners.

HOW-TO · QUACKSYNC · STEP 1 OF 6

Paste your value proposition, not a feature list



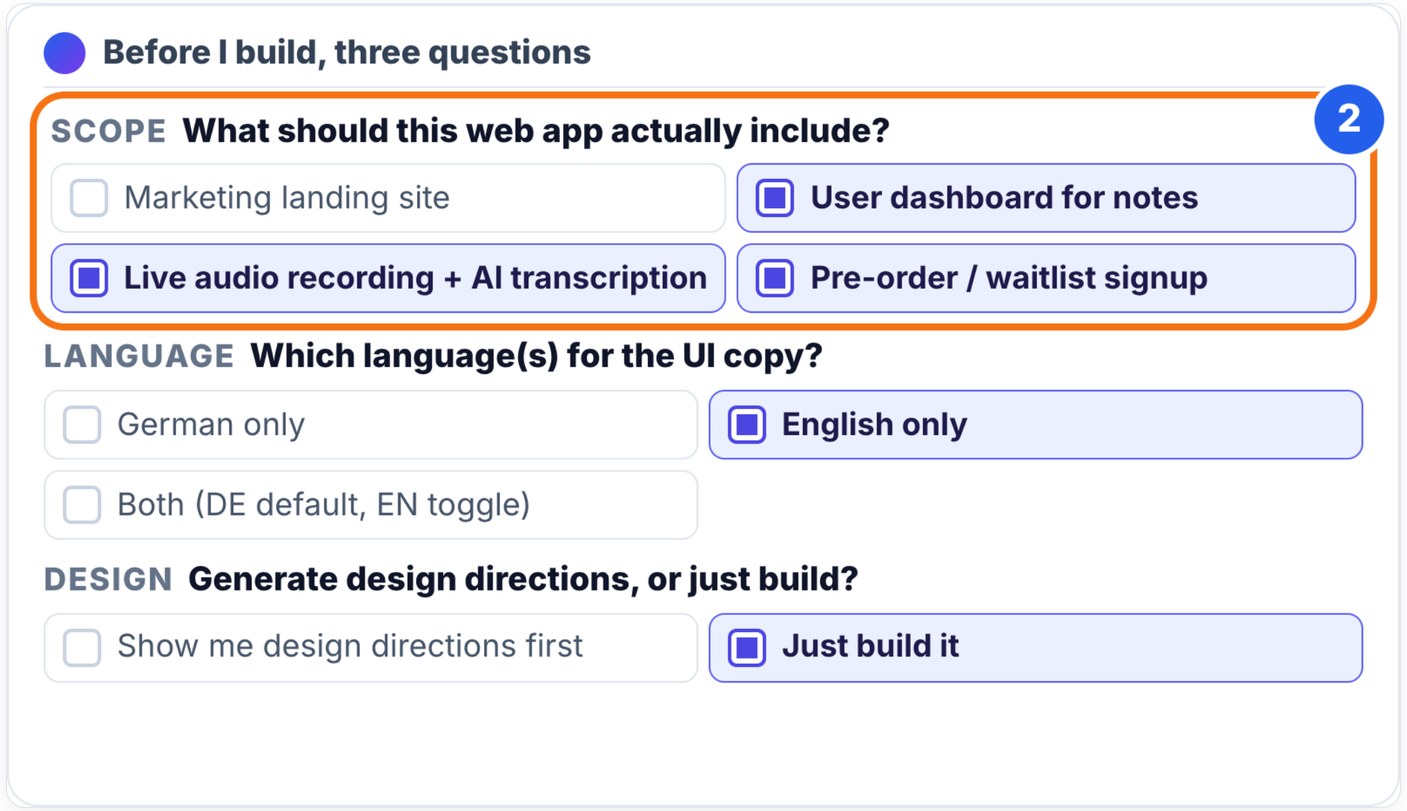
1. **Paste your pitch**
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

Segment, pain, value.
No tech stack.

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped for this course, the pitch word for word from the course's run in Lovable. QuackSync is a made-up venture.

HOW-TO · QUACKSYNC · STEP 2 OF 6

It asks before it builds. Tick one box



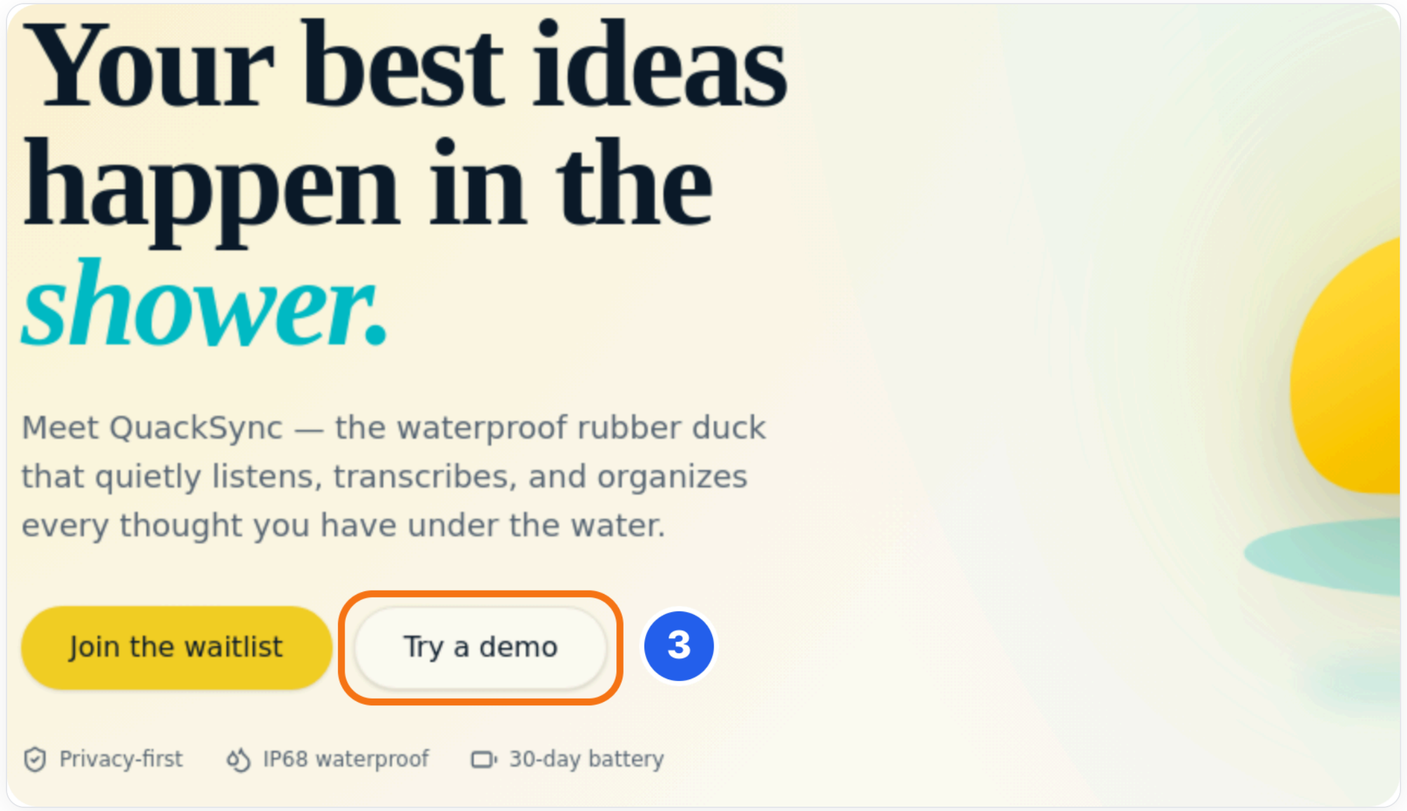
1. Paste your pitch
2. **Answer narrowly**
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

A click dummy needs the one path. Not a dashboard, not audio.

ILLUSTRATIVE Lovable's questions and Bastian's answers, QuackSync project log, 23 June 2026, word for word. Layout prototyped for this course.

HOW-TO · QUACKSYNC · STEP 3 OF 6

Half an hour later, you can click it



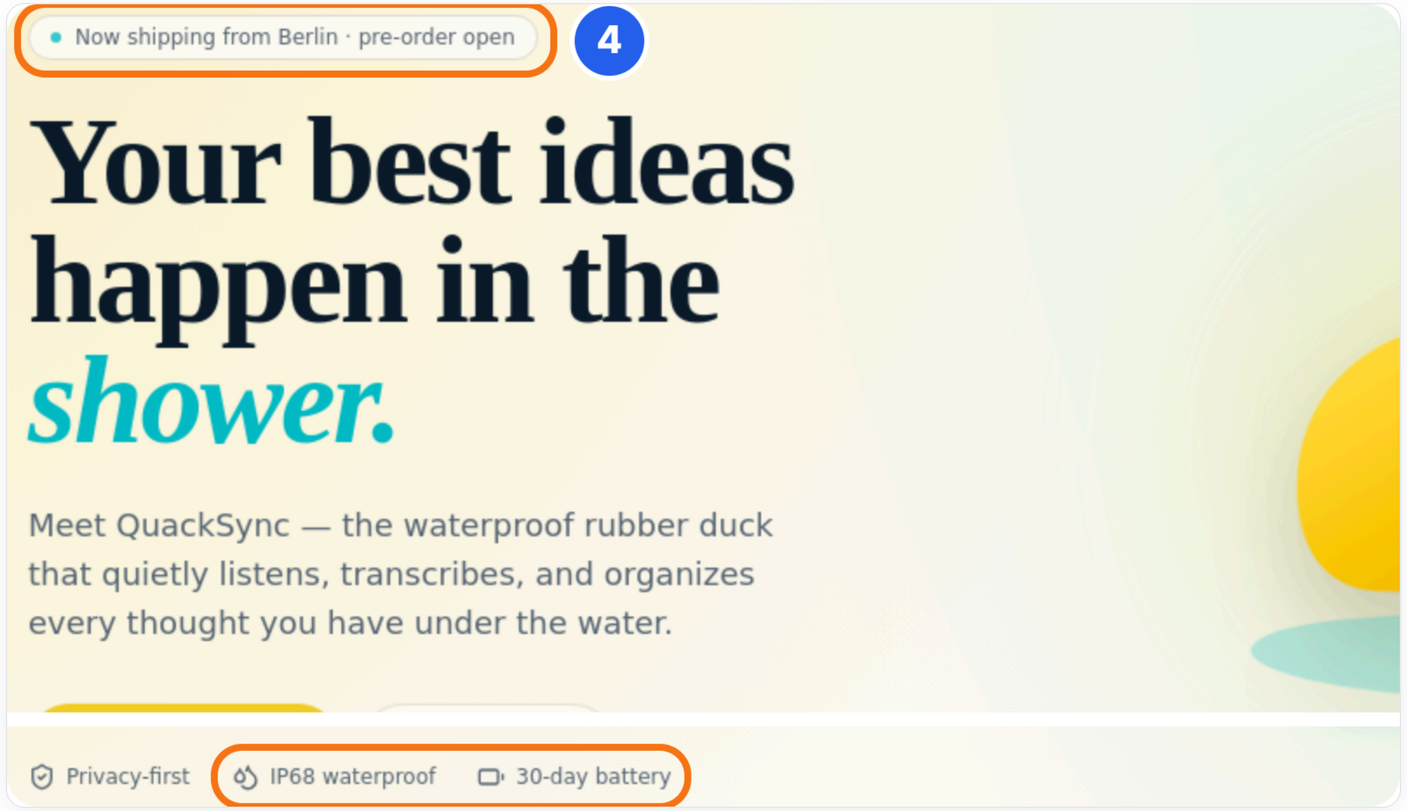
Lovable

1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. **Click through**
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

36 minutes from the first prompt to the last edit.

HOW-TO · QUACKSYNC · STEP 4 OF 6

Delete what the builder made up

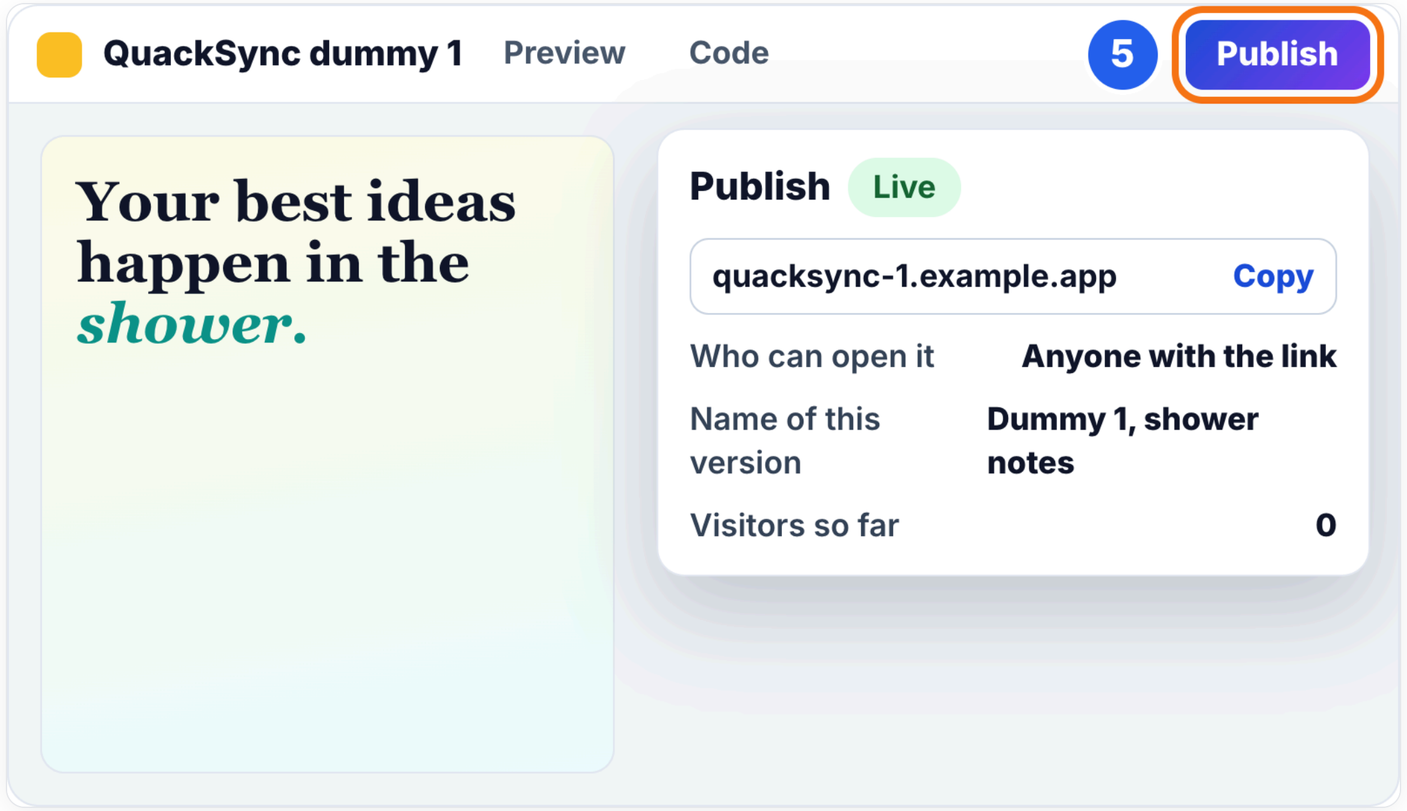


1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. **Delete inventions**
5. Publish one link
6. Link your button

"Now shipping." "IP68." "30-day battery." Nobody said so. The builder invented it.

HOW-TO · QUACKSYNC · STEP 5 OF 6

Publish, then share one link



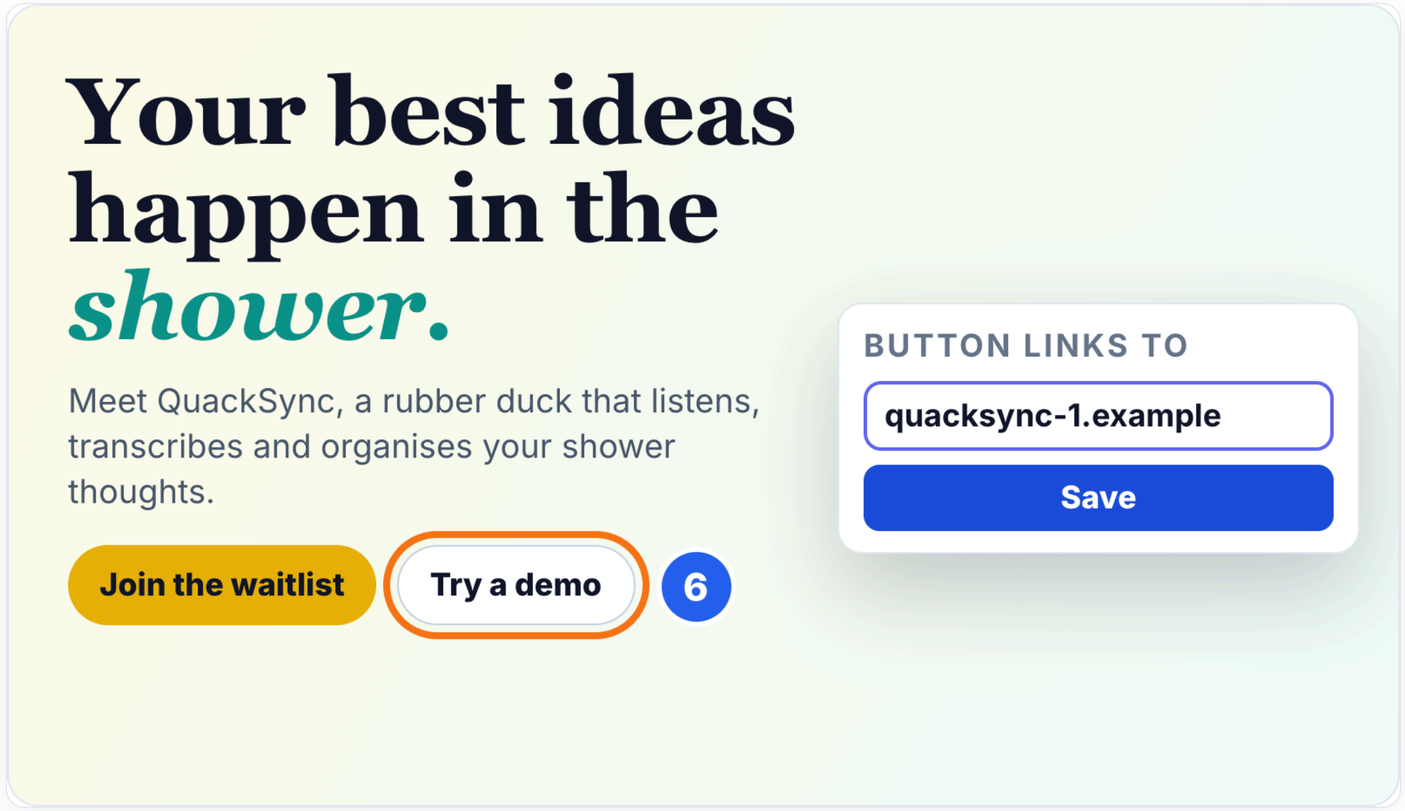
1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. **Publish one link**
6. Link your button

One link per dummy. Name it, so you know which one they saw.

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped for this course. QuackSync is a made-up venture.

HOW-TO · QUACKSYNC · STEP 6 OF 6

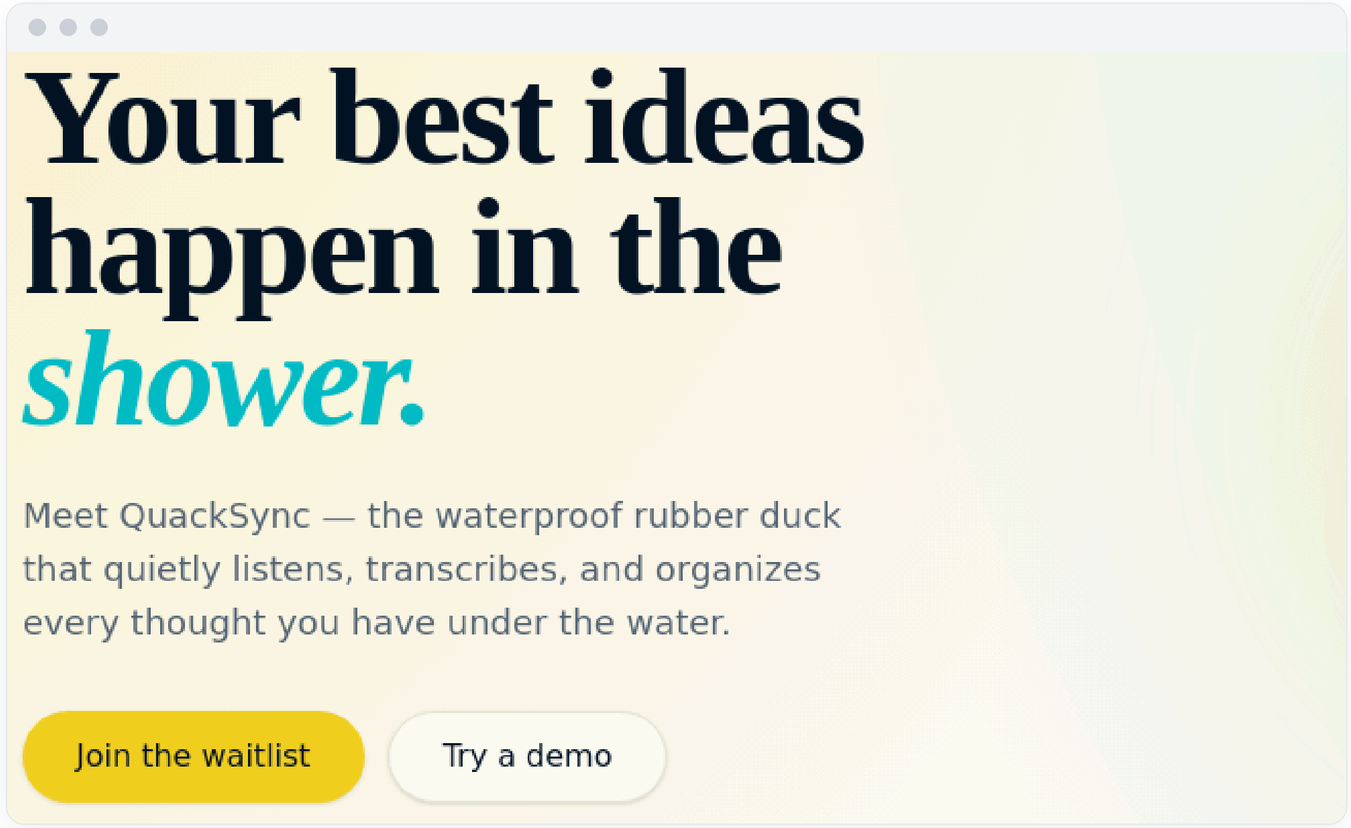
Put it behind your page's button



1. Paste your pitch
2. Answer narrowly
3. Click through
4. Delete inventions
5. Publish one link
6. **Link your button**

Only after your Validating problems (M04) result is logged. The line never moves.

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped for this course, headline and buttons from the real QuackSync page. QuackSync is a made-up venture.



TOOLS · AS OF OCTOBER 2026

Any builder works. Pick one

Lovable ↗
5 free credits a day

Figma Make ↗
500 AI credits a month free

Replit ↗
1 free app, offline after 30 days

Framer ↗
500 AI credits to try

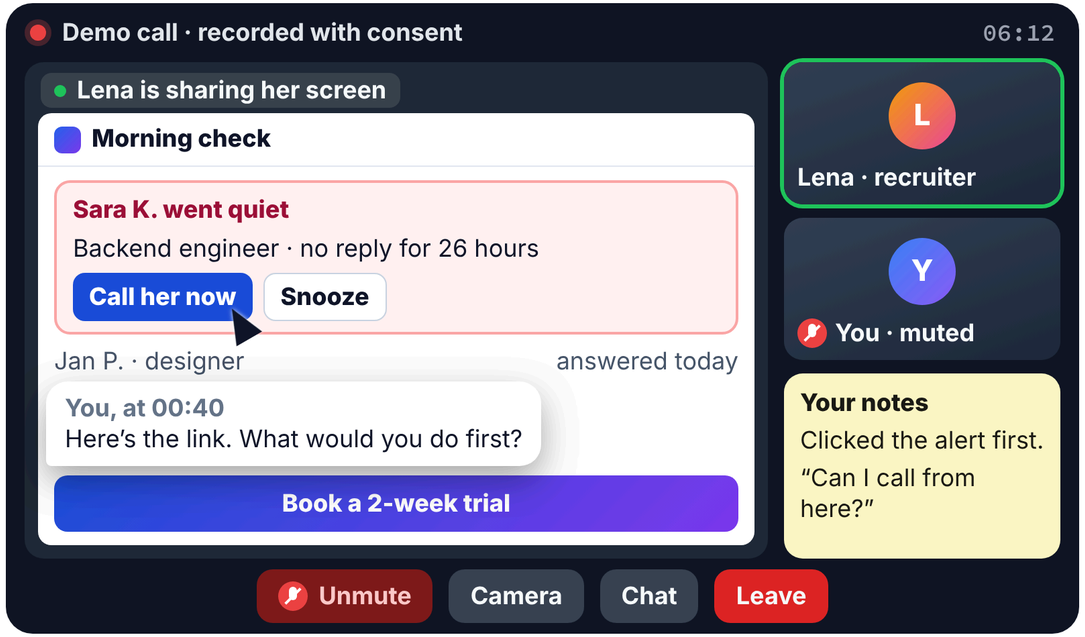
DATA Vendor pricing pages, opened 19 October 2026. Blomfield, T. (2025). How to get the most out of vibe coding. Y Combinator. Logos are trademarks of their owners. QuackSync in Lovable, 23 June 2026, cropped.

DEMOS

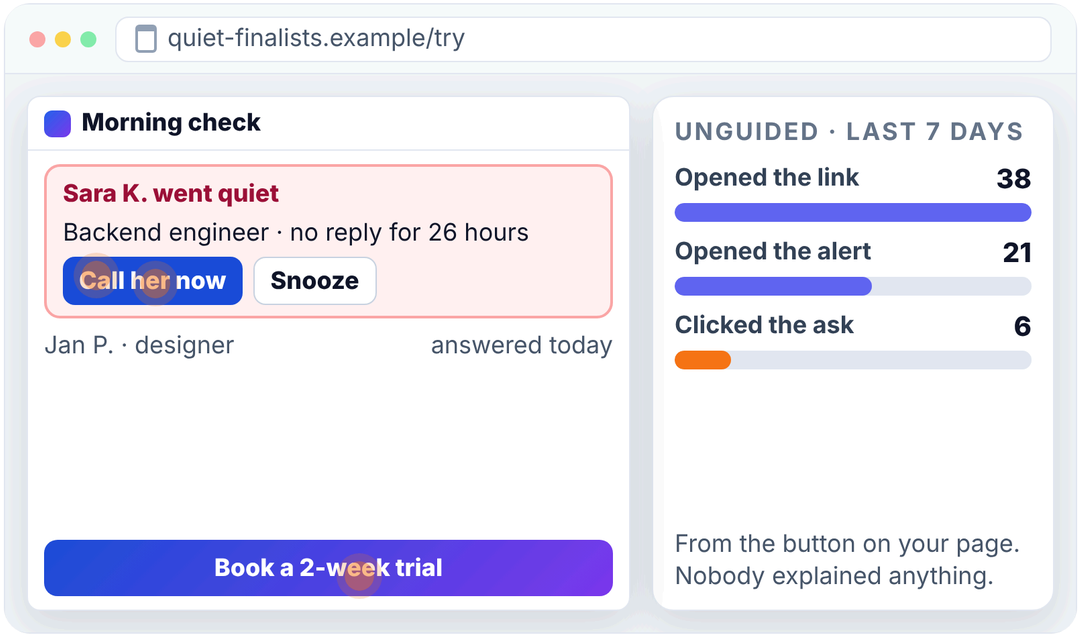
Use guided or unguided demos

Depending on your use case. Usually both

Guided · you lead



Unguided · they decide



GUIDED DEMOS · TIP 1 OF 3

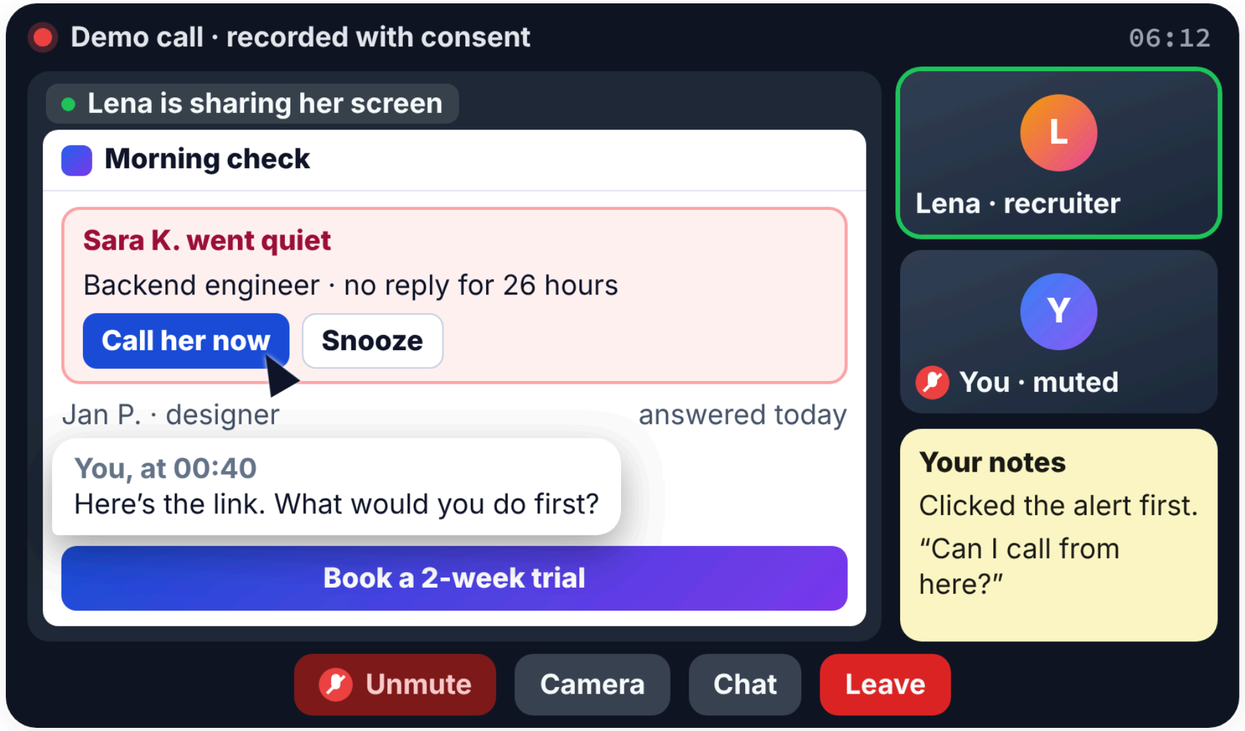
Let them drive. You stay quiet

FROM

"Let me show you how it works."

TO

"Here's the link. What would you do first?"



GUIDED DEMOS · TIP 2 OF 3

Ask about today, not about your dummy

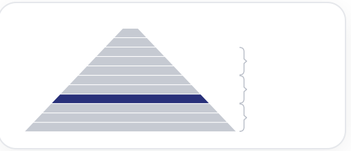
FROM

"Do you like it?"

TO

"What did you do the last time this happened?"





GUIDED DEMOS · TIP 3 OF 3

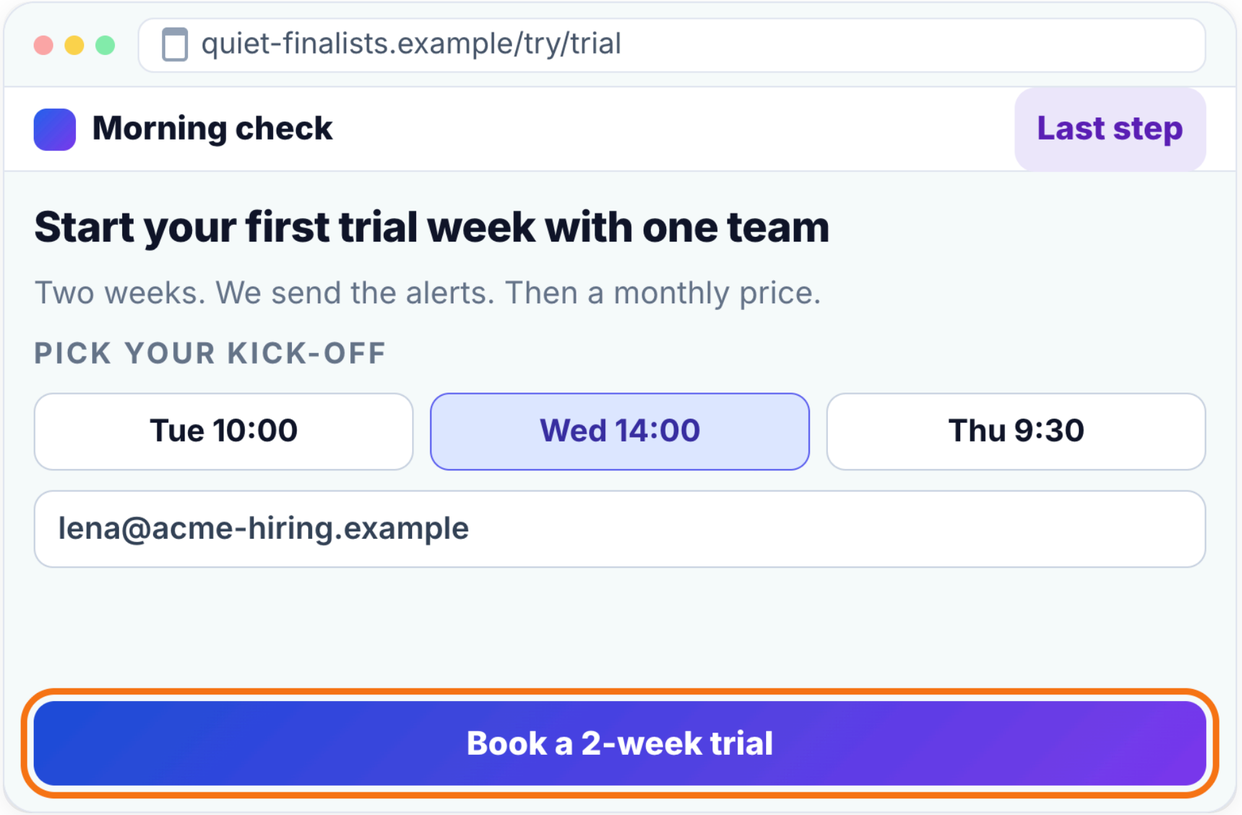
End with an ask that costs something

FROM

"Would you use this?"

TO

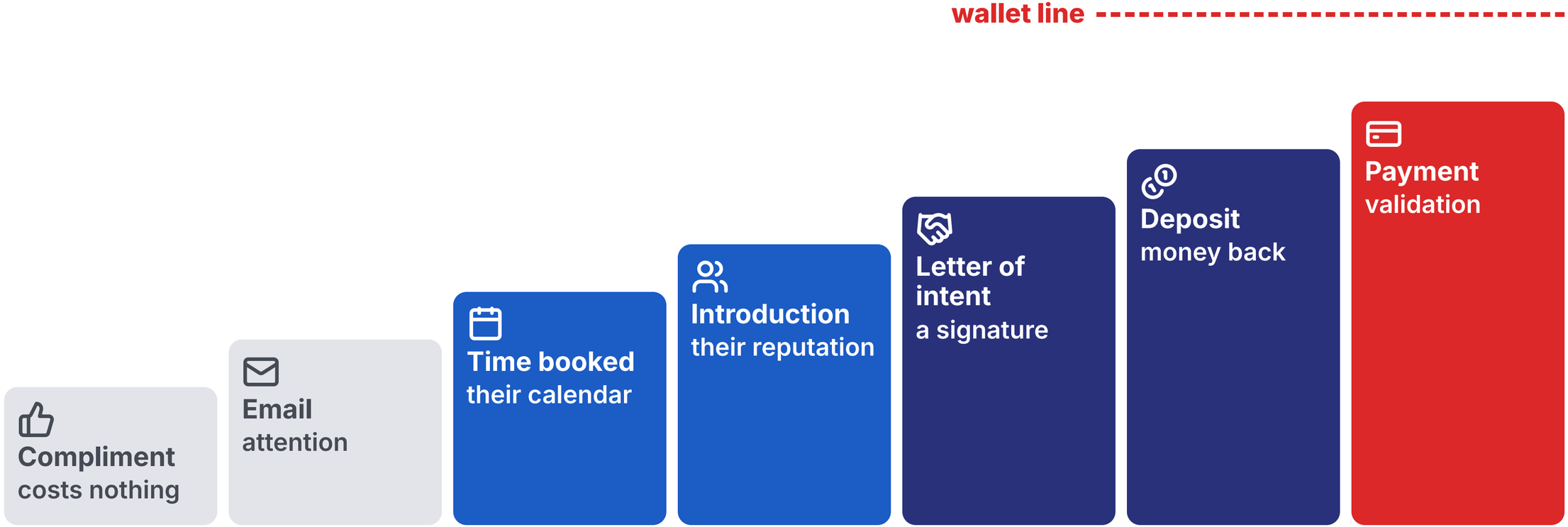
"Can we book your first trial week now?"



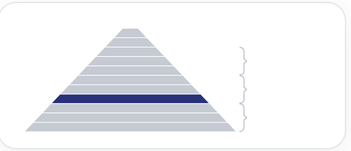
THE ASK

Climb the ask until it costs them something

Signal below the wallet line, validation above it



FRAMEWORK Course framework 01, Mom Test cheatsheet, rule 4 (time, money, reputation or access), after Fitzpatrick, R. (2013). Course Glossary.

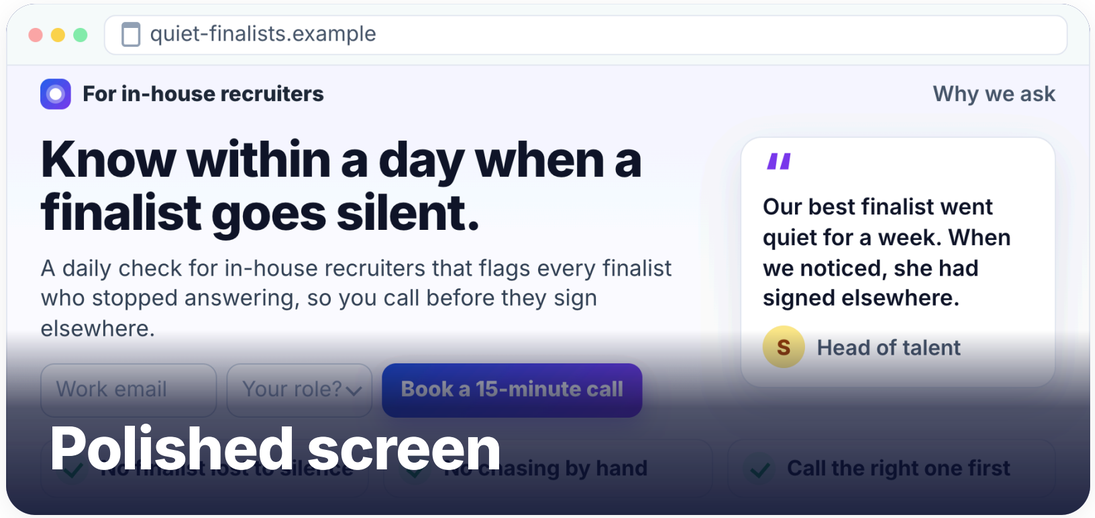


RESEARCH

Rough finds the same problems as polished

Sketched and HTML websites, on paper and on screen





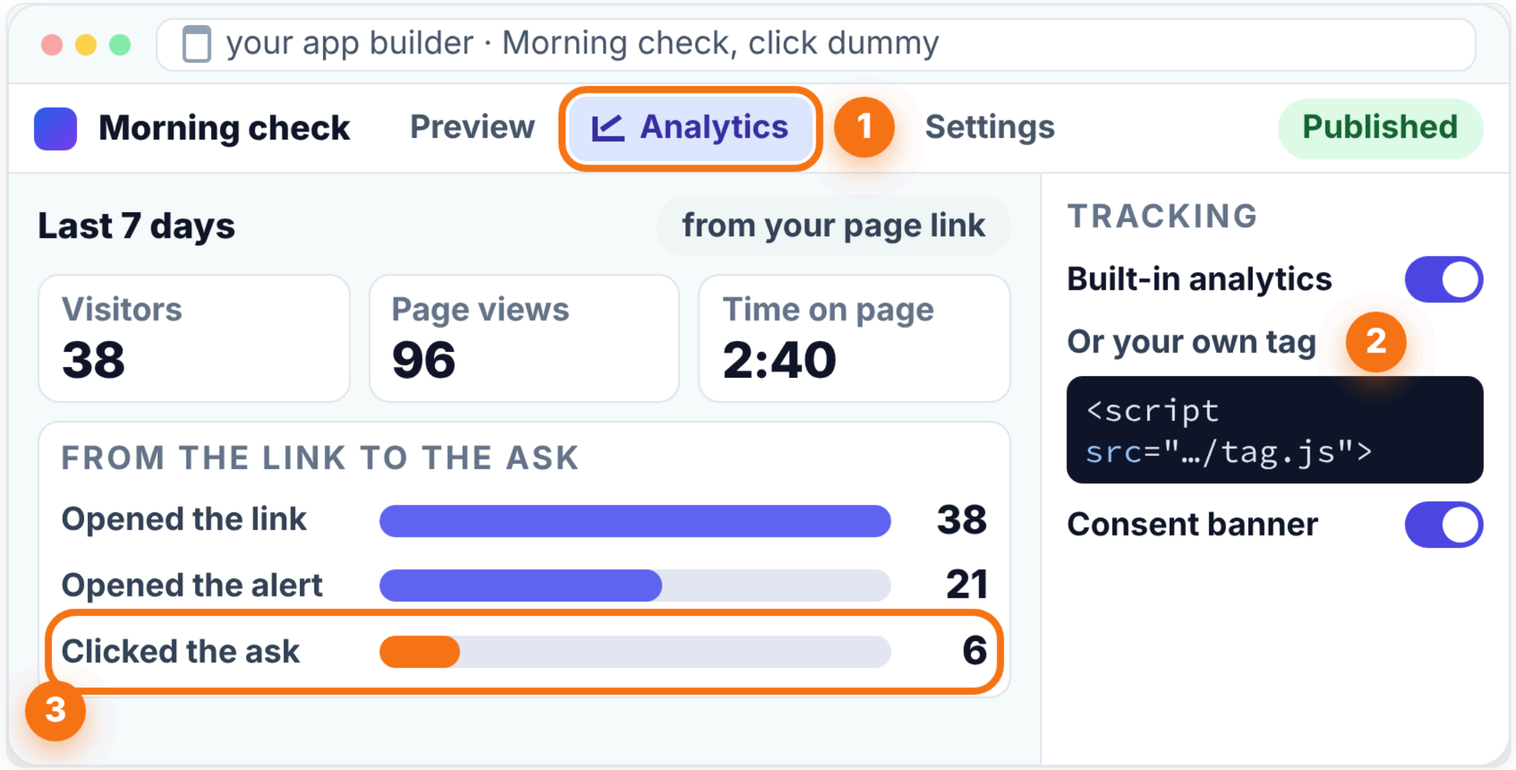
Both find substantially the same usability problems

But rough prototypes mislead on task times and looks. Test whether people want it with the ask

RESEARCH Walker, Takayama & Landay (2002). Virzi, Sokolov & Karis (1996). Sauer & Sonderegger (2009). *Applied Ergonomics*, 40(4), 60 participants.
Photo: Pexels on Pixabay.

SHOW THE REAL THING · ANALYTICS

Watch what they do when you're not there



1. **Turn on analytics**
2. **Or add your tag**
3. **Count who reached the ask**

Consent rules from Validating problems (M04) apply here too.

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped for this course, names and numbers made up.

AI is not paying for your service, real humans are!

AI testers find broken flows. They never count as evidence.

RESEARCH Hämäläinen et al. (2023), CHI. Bisbee et al. (2024), *Political Analysis*. Rosala & Moran (2024), Nielsen Norman Group.

SPEED MATTERS

Before you decide, show every dummy at least

7 times

To people from your segment, in guided demos.
Then read your line, keep the winner, bin the rest.

NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

Write your ask

Who — Three sign-ups you will message today

Path — The 3 screens to the one feature

Ask — What it costs them

If yes — What happens next

If no — What you ask instead

3:00

OUTPUT

Three names, one ask

INPUT 4 OF 4 · SHOW IT · THE ANSWERS

Show it: they drive, you end with an ask

1

How fast can you build a click dummy?

In hours with an AI builder. Ours took 36 minutes

2

How do you show it?

Guided demos where they drive and you stay quiet, and unguided behind your page

3

What counts as a result?

An ask that costs them something. A dummy collects signal, only a payment validates

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

Wrap-up and check-out

Two pictures to keep, three questions to reflect on, and your week.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Widen it: many solutions to one problem~~

04 ~~Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing~~

05 ~~Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand~~

06 ~~Show it: a click dummy people try~~

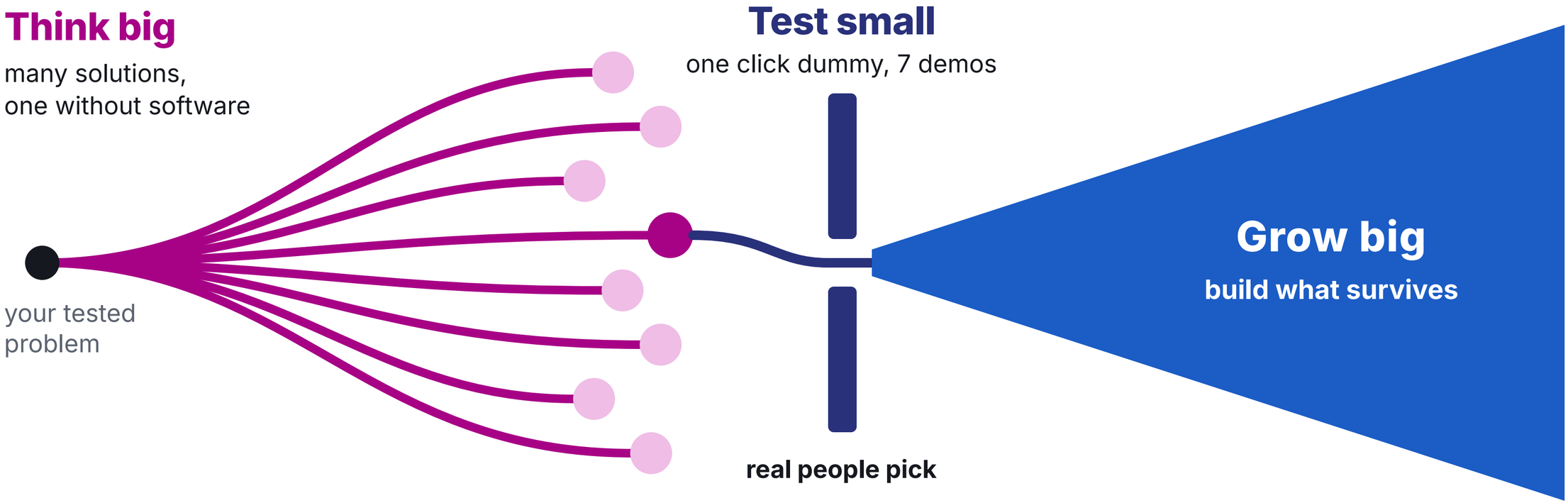
07 **Wrap-up and check-out**

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 Case discussion

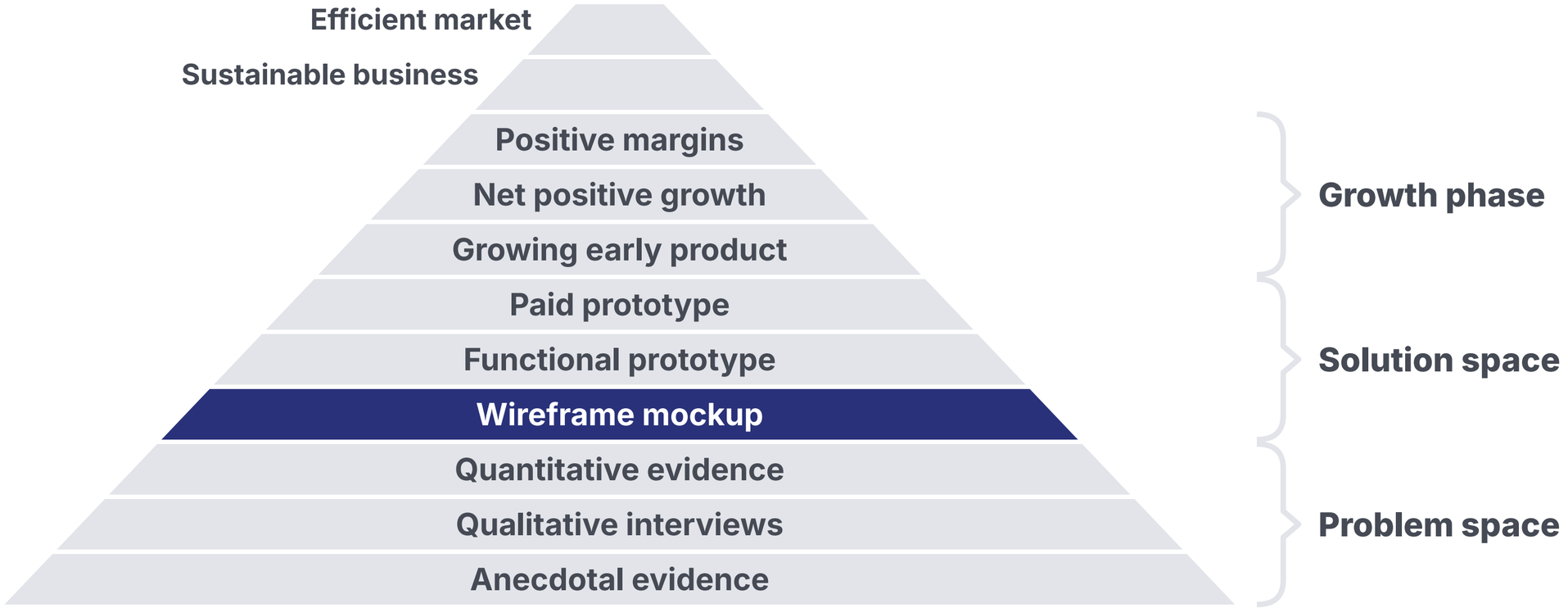
RECAP · TODAY

You went wide, then tested small



RECAP · RUNG FOUR

From today you climb to the mock-up



REFLECTION 1 OF 3 · THE CONTENT

What could you apply?



What could you apply?



What gave you a hard time?

REFLECTION 2 OF 3 · THE PROCESS

Man vs. machine



Where did AI actually help you?



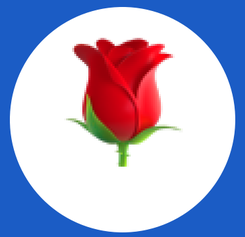
Where was your genius needed?



What are your best hacks to share?

REFLECTION 3 OF 3 · THE RESULTS

Rose, thorn, bud



What was the breakthrough today?



What was the hardest part today?



What is an idea/feature you didn't have time to finish, but want to explore later?

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Build one click dummy per founder and show the dummies in 15 guided demos per student with people from your segment, at least 7 per dummy, each ending in an ask that costs them something.

15 demos each

The learning floor is one click dummy per team and 5 such demos per student.

Your line: fewer than 2 of the first 7 people from your segment accept a dummy's ask, and that dummy goes.

HOMEWORK · HOW TO DO IT

Let them drive. End with an ask

1. **Build with your AI builder in 4 hours or less.** Rebuild, don't patch.
2. **Book sign-ups first,** then interviewees, then your segment's groups.
3. **Let them drive.** Share the link in a call. Watch, stay quiet.

! **Watch out.** Explaining makes it a pitch.

4. **End with the ask,** a trial slot or a pre-order. Only a payment validates.
5. **Converge midweek.** Keep the dummy with the most accepted asks.
6. **Write your MVP.** One feature, what stays manual, the price.
7. **Put the winner behind your page's button** once your Validating problems (M04) result is logged. Those clicks are signal, not demos.
8. **Get a blind second opinion.** Give an AI your raw notes, minus hypothesis and names. Note where it disagrees.

HOMEWORK · NOTHING BY HAND

Every demo lands in your log. Your agent writes it

Student Toolkit · Interview Log · your team

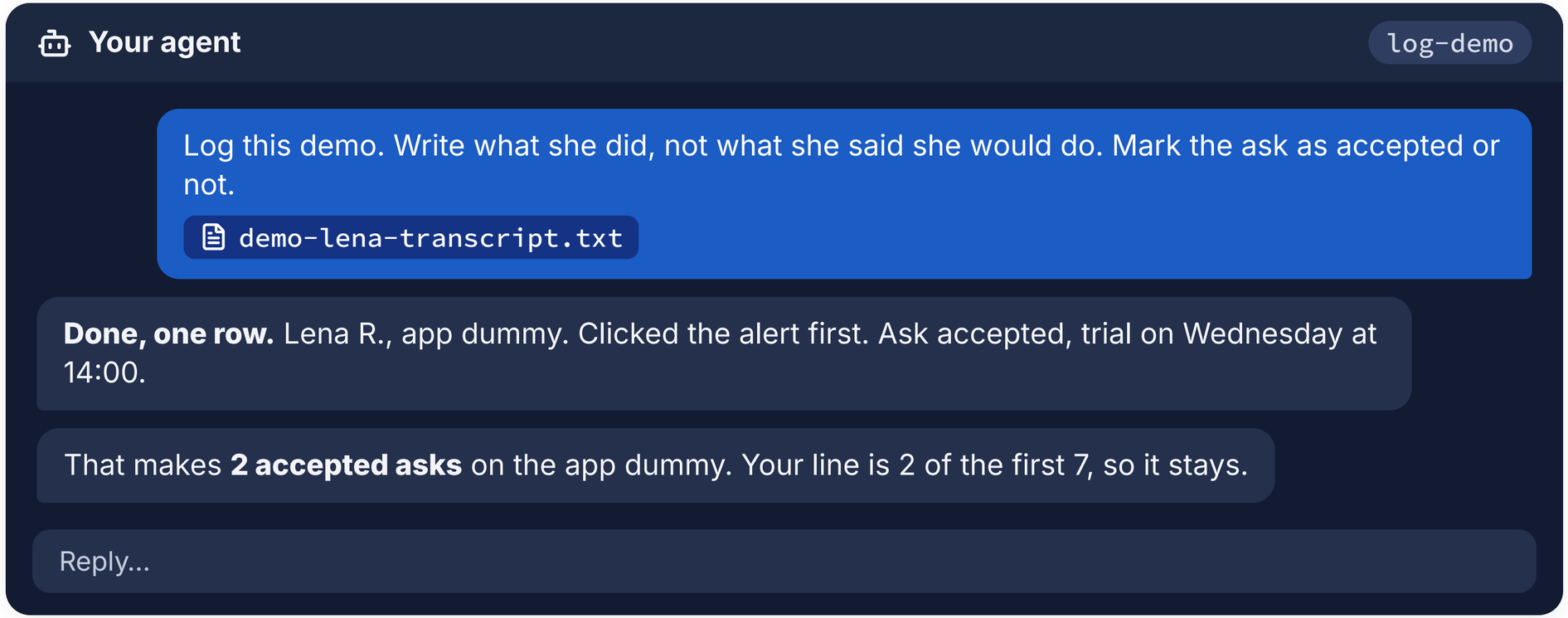
Interviewee	Role/Persona	Dummy	Key Insight #1	Notable Quote	Agreed next step
Lena R.	In-house recruiter	**App**	Clicked the alert first, no help needed	"Can I call from here?"	**Trial booked, Wed 14:00**
Sam O.	Head of talent	**App**	Asked who else sees the alert	"My team needs this on Monday."	**Intro to her team lead**
Ayla D.	In-house recruiter	**Service**	Would not hand finalists to a stranger	"They are my candidates."	"Keep me posted"
Jonas P.	Recruiter, scale-up	**Check-in**	Liked it, then asked what it costs	"Friday is too late for us."	No next step

Dashboard | **Interview Log** | Team | Ideas | Experiment Tracker | Kill Criteria Log

ILLUSTRATIVE The Interview Log of your Student Toolkit, filled in for the workshop's made-up team. Names made up. Screen prototyped for this course.

WITH YOUR AGENT

Every demo lands in your log. Your agent writes it



ILLUSTRATIVE The Interview Log of your Student Toolkit, filled in for the workshop's made-up team. Names made up. Screen prototyped for this course.

HOMEWORK · WHAT YOU COME BACK WITH

Good is heard, counted and asked for

	GOOD	WEAK
10X	"An hour, not a week", heard in 9 demos	"Faster", assumed
DEMOS	45 guided, 3 dummies	12 friends clicked
ASKS	8 trials booked, 1 deposit	"Keep me posted"

ILLUSTRATIVE What you come back with, Solution space (M05) homework. The examples follow the made-up recruiting venture.

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See you next time!

MODULE 05 · WORKSHOP · 90 MINUTES

Workshop: Build a click dummy, book the demos

Every founder builds one click dummy and books the first demos.

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 **Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos**

09 Case discussion

WORKSHOP · STEP 1 OF 3

Go wide, then pick by 10x

1 STEP 1 · 25 MIN

GO WIDE, THEN PICK BY 10X

Real options, judged against what your segment uses today

→ Read your Validating problems (M04) line next to your result
→ Name the status quo and what it costs
→ Three solutions per founder, one without software, then ask AI
→ Keep one each, under 10 words, one 10x dimension
→ Log the line, dated, before anyone sees a dummy

Output One pick per founder, a dated line **Minutes** 25



25:00

Solution space (M05) workshop. Photo: geralt on Pixabay.

WORKSHOP · STEP 2 OF 3

From text to interface

2 STEP 2 · 40 MIN

FROM TEXT TO INTERFACE

A dummy that shows one feature and ends with an ask

→ Cut to the one feature your segment cares about
→ The screen shows the outcome, the rest stays manual
→ Prompt the builder: one path, 1 to 5 prompts
→ The last screen asks for a trial slot, LOI or pre-order
→ Rehearse with another team. Classmates never count

Output One link per founder, ending in an ask **Minutes** 40



40:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 3 OF 3

First demos, then commit

3 STEP 3 · 25 MIN

FIRST DEMOS, THEN COMMIT

Leave with demos on the calendar

- → Message sign-ups, Problem space (M03) interviewees, then segment groups
- → Run a demo now if someone answers
- → They click, you watch, log it in the Interview Log
- → Each student picks floor or full bar
- → Set your midweek day for reading the line

Output Booked demos, targets, midweek day **Minutes** 25



25:00

ARRIVED EMPTY-HANDED?

Start from your interviews

No sign-ups? Work from your interviews, proof assumed. Switched segment? Post your dummy in the new segment's groups.



Solution space (M05) workshop. Photo: picjumbo_com on Pixabay.

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Build one click dummy per founder and show the dummies in 15 guided demos per student with people from your segment, at least 7 per dummy, each ending in an ask that costs them something.

15 demos each

The learning floor is one click dummy per team and 5 such demos per student.

Your line: fewer than 2 of the first 7 people from your segment accept a dummy's ask, and that dummy goes.

See you next time!

MODULE 05 · CASE DISCUSSION · ABOUT 90 MINUTES

Case discussion: Freeletics

Stand with three Munich founders in April 2013 and decide what goes on sale by Monday.

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Widen it: many solutions to one problem**

04 **Sharpen it: ten times better on one thing**

05 **Cut it: one feature, the rest by hand**

06 **Show it: a click dummy people try**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: build a click dummy, book the demos

09 **Case discussion**

CASE · FREELETICS GBR, MUNICH, A THURSDAY IN APRIL 2013 · VOTE 1 OF 2

There is no money left. What is on sale on Monday?



OPTION 1

An e-book with the workouts

Hands

OPTION 2

The weekly parts at €1.99 as they stand

Hands

OPTION 3

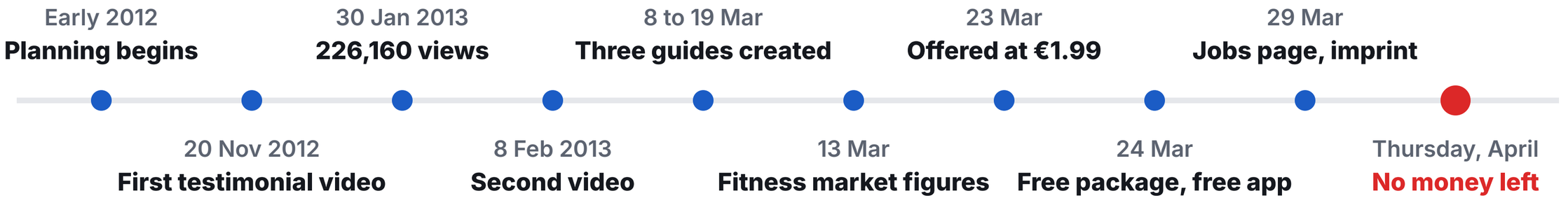
Nothing new until the app

Hands

DATA Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, "What Could Be Sold by Monday". Option 1 is the one a founder named. Options 2 and 3 were plainly available. Photo, not of the company: Keifit on Pixabay.

CASE · WHAT HAPPENED UNTIL APRIL 2013

Everything before one Thursday



DATA Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, Exhibit 3. Nothing after April 2013.

CASE · EXHIBIT 1

What the shop offered, 23 to 29 March 2013

PAGE	CAPTURED	WHAT IT OFFERED	PRICE
Home page	24 March	A Basic Package of workouts for an email address	Free
Product list	23 and 29 March	Cardio&Strength, Cardio and Strength Training Guide	€1.99 each
Cardio&Strength guide	24 March	Part 1, workouts and schedules for one week, download link within 15 minutes	€1.99 per part
Cardio guide	28 and 29 March	Parts 1 and 2	€1.99 per part
App	24 March	A free training app, linked to Apple's App Store	Free
Jobs	29 March	A call for mobile developers	

DATA Compiled by the case writer from Internet Archive captures of freeletics.myshopify.com, 23 to 29 March 2013 (case Exhibit 1, shortened).

CASE · STATUS QUO · 15 MINUTES

Against what did Freeletics compete?

And where could it be ten times better?

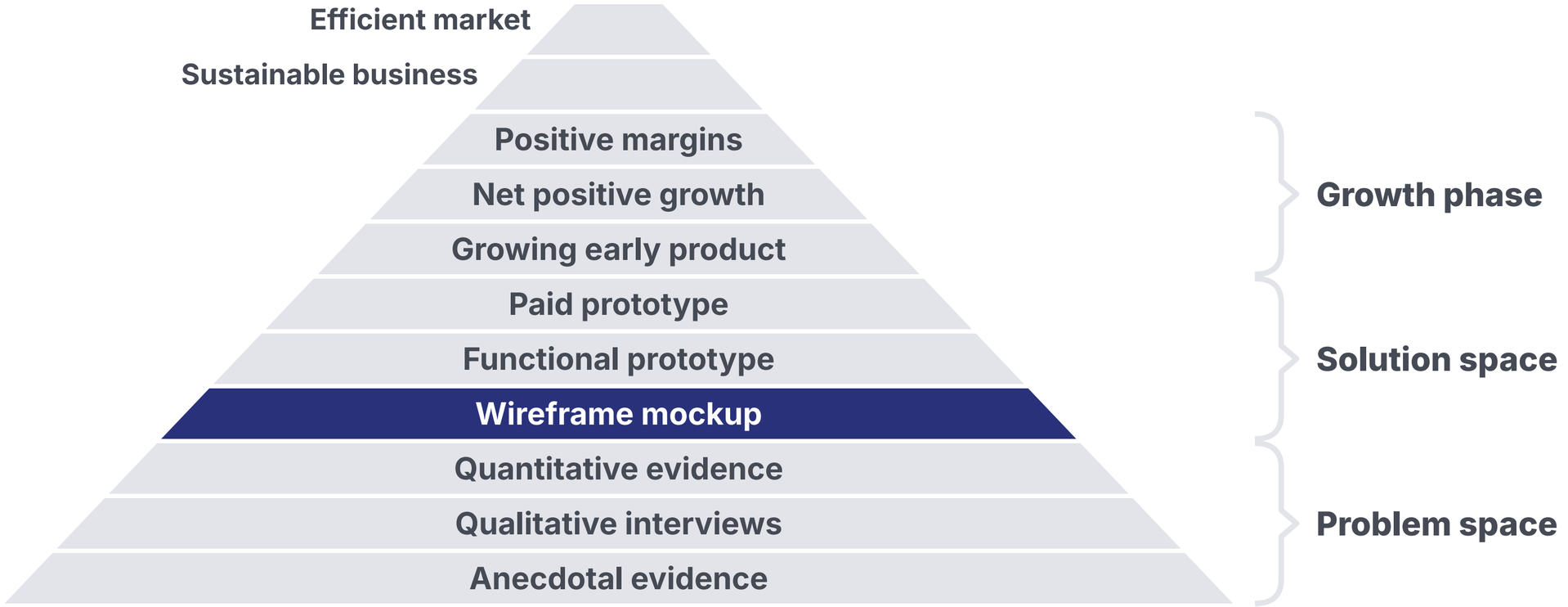
GERMAN FITNESS MARKET, END OF 2012	VALUE
Members of fitness facilities, 2012	7.9 million
Fitness facilities	7,566
Average membership fee, gross, 2012	€45.42
Industry revenue	€3.8 billion
Market share of chains	47.2 percent



DATA DSSV and Deloitte, press release on "Der deutsche Fitnessmarkt 2013", 13 March 2013, translated by the case writer (case Exhibit 4, shortened). The fee's period is not stated, about €40 a month by the case writer's check. Photo: lewisgoodphotos on Pixabay.

CASE · EVIDENCE · 15 MINUTES

What did people do that cost them something?



CASE · THE SMALLEST OFFER AND THE LINE · 30 MINUTES

What could ship by Monday, and what stays manual?

Then, which form would you have kept, and by what line?

Forms on 29 March with or without software	**What people did** heard, measured, assumed	**Signal or payment** which could validate?	**The smallest offer** shows, manual, price

DATA Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, Exhibits 1 and 3. Column 4 holds your answers to pre-read question 2.

CASE · VOTE 2 OF 2

Same question. Who moved, and why?



OPTION 1

An e-book with the workouts

Hands

OPTION 2

The weekly parts at €1.99 as they stand

Hands

OPTION 3

Nothing new until the app

Hands

DATA Solution space (M05) case: Freeletics, "What Could Be Sold by Monday". Option 1 is the one a founder named. Options 2 and 3 were plainly available. Photo, not of the company: Keifit on Pixabay.

See you next time!